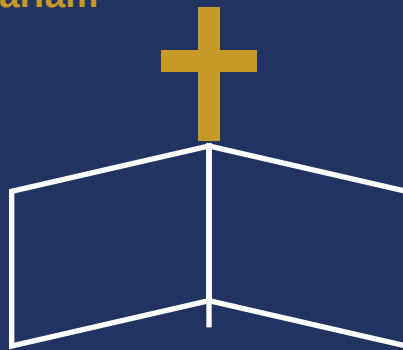


THE COMPLETE COLLECTION

Christian Study Workbooks

Ten complete study workbooks for teens and young adults, ages 13-19 - devotionals, inductive Bible study, word studies, reflection, and application.

Written by **Daniel Tesfamariam**



10 Books - 510 Pages - Ages 13-19

Christian Homeschool Press - Reproducible for one household or class

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FAITH FOUNDATIONS STUDY SERIES

Christian Bible Learning Workbook

A Teen & Young Adult Guide to Reading, Understanding, and Living the Bible

Written by Daniel Tesfamariam



Ages 13-19 - Homeschool & Youth Groups

Personal Study - Small Groups - Reproducible for one household or class

HOW TO USE THIS STUDY

Getting the Most From This Workbook

This workbook is built for students ages 13 to 19 who want more than Sunday-school answers. Over six units you will learn how the Bible is put together, how to read it for yourself, and how to move from information to transformation. Each unit includes a devotional, an inductive study you drive, a word study, journaling, and either a discussion or a real-world challenge.

2 TIMOTHY 3:16

"All Scripture is God-breathed and is useful for teaching, rebuking, correcting and training in righteousness."

A Few Suggestions

- ☐ Find a consistent time and place. Even 15 focused minutes beats an hour you never start.
- ☐ Keep a pen in hand. Writing your answers turns reading into real thinking.
- ☐ Read each passage in your own Bible too, and note the version differences.
- ☐ Be honest in the reflection and journal sections - no one is grading you.
- ☐ If you meet with a group, come having already written your answers.
- ☐ Pray before you begin. Ask God to teach you, not just inform you.

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UNIT 1

Why the Bible Matters

"Your word is a lamp for my feet, a light on my path." - Psalm 119:105

Unit Overview

Before we open the Bible, we ask what it even is and why anyone should build a life on it. This unit frames Scripture as God's self-revelation, not a rulebook.

DEVOTIONAL

More Than a Book

You have probably owned a Bible longer than you have actually read one. This unit is about changing that.

HEBREWS 4:12

"The word of God is alive and active, sharper than any double-edged sword."

Notice the verse does not say the Bible was alive when it was written; it says it is alive now. Scripture reads you as much as you read it.

Many teens quit the Bible because they treat it like a textbook to finish. It is better understood as a conversation with the God who wrote it and is still speaking through it.

Reflect

1. What has your relationship with the Bible been like so far - honestly?

2. What would change in your week if you believed God actually speaks through these words?

PRAYER PROMPT

God, make your word alive to me. Give me hunger for it and eyes to understand.

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - OBSERVE

The Two Foundations

Read the passage slowly, more than once. First notice what it actually says before deciding what it means.

MATTHEW 7:24-27

"Therefore everyone who hears these words of mine and puts them into practice is like a wise man who built his house on the rock. The rain came down, the streams rose, and the winds blew and beat against that house; yet it did not fall, because it had its foundation on the rock. But everyone who hears these words of mine and does not put them into practice is like a foolish man who built his house on sand."

Observation - What does it say?

1. What do both builders have in common?

2. What is the single difference between them?

3. What do the storms represent in a real teenager's life?

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - INTERPRET & APPLY

The Two Foundations

Interpretation - What does it mean?

1. Why does Jesus tie wisdom to doing and not just hearing?

2. What does building on sand look like for someone your age today?

Application - What will I do?

1. Where in your life are you currently hearing but not doing?

2. What is one area you can start building on rock this week?

WORD STUDY

Truth

MEANING

Reality as God defines it - not merely accurate facts, but what is trustworthy, faithful, and real. In John, Jesus calls himself the Truth.

Where It Appears**JOHN 8:32**

"Then you will know the truth, and the truth will set you free."

JOHN 17:17

"Sanctify them by the truth; your word is truth."

Dig Deeper

1. Our culture says truth is whatever you personally feel. How does the Bible challenge that?

2. How can truth be freeing rather than limiting?

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

Where I'm Starting

Describe your current spiritual life in a few honest sentences.

What do you hope is different by the end of this workbook?

What is one question about God or the Bible you have never gotten a real answer to?

FAITH & WORLDVIEW

Can We Trust the Bible?

THE QUESTION

Is the Bible reliable, or was it just made up and edited over time?

Think It Through**Manuscript evidence**

There are more early copies of the New Testament than of any other ancient document, and they agree with remarkable consistency.

Honest reporting

The Bible records the failures of its own heroes - an odd choice for a fabricated legend meant to promote them.

Unity

Written by dozens of authors across roughly 1,500 years, it tells one connected story pointing to Christ.

Your Response

1. Which of these points is most convincing to you, and why?

2. What objection do you still have - and who could help you explore it?

UNIT 2

How the Bible Is Organized

"Do your best to present yourself to God as one who correctly handles the word of truth." - 2 Timothy 2:15

Unit Overview

You cannot navigate a library you do not understand. This unit maps the 66 books, the two testaments, and the main genres so reading stops feeling random.

DEVOTIONAL

Learning the Map

Imagine trying to use a phone with no home screen. That is what the Bible feels like until you learn its layout.

2 TIMOTHY 2:15

"Do your best to present yourself to God as one approved, a worker who correctly handles the word of truth."

The Bible is a library of 66 books: history, law, poetry, prophecy, biography, and letters. Reading a psalm the way you read a legal contract will confuse you.

Knowing the genre of what you are reading is the first step to reading it well.

Reflect

1. Which parts of the Bible have you found most confusing, and could genre be part of why?

2. How might reading Proverbs differently from Romans help you?

PRAYER PROMPT

Lord, give me patience to learn how your word is put together.

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - OBSERVE

A Guide to Understanding

Read the passage slowly, more than once. First notice what it actually says before deciding what it means.

NEHEMIAH 8:5-8

"Ezra opened the book. All the people could see him because he was standing above them; and as he opened it, the people all stood up. The Levites instructed the people in the Law while the people were standing there. They read from the Book of the Law of God, making it clear and giving the meaning so that the people understood what was being read."

Observation - What does it say?

1. What did the people do when the book was opened?

2. What did the Levites add to the reading?

3. What was the goal of all this effort?

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - INTERPRET & APPLY

A Guide to Understanding

Interpretation - What does it mean?

1. Why is explanation, not just reading, sometimes necessary?

2. What does this teach about studying with others?

Application - What will I do?

1. Who helps you understand the Bible? Who could you ask?

2. What tool (study Bible, app, mentor) will you start using?

WORD STUDY

Testament

MEANING

A covenant or binding agreement. The Old Testament records God's covenant with Israel; the New Testament, the new covenant established through Jesus.

Where It Appears**LUKE 22:20**

"This cup is the new covenant in my blood, which is poured out for you."

2 CORINTHIANS 3:6

"He has made us competent as ministers of a new covenant."

Dig Deeper

1. What is 'new' about the new covenant compared to the old?

2. How does seeing the Bible as one covenant story change how you read it?

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

My Reading Plan

Which book of the Bible will you read first, and why?

What time of day realistically works for you to read?

What obstacles usually stop you, and how will you handle them this time?

SMALL GROUP DISCUSSION

Talk It Over

Share openly. The goal is not to sound spiritual but to be honest.

1. What surprised you about how the Bible is organized?

2. Which genre are you most drawn to - story, poetry, letters - and why?

3. How can this group help each other actually keep reading?

UNIT 3

Reading for Yourself

"Like newborn babies, crave pure spiritual milk, so that by it you may grow up in your salvation." - 1 Peter 2:2

Unit Overview

This unit teaches a simple, repeatable method: observe, interpret, apply. Once you own it, you can study any passage without depending on someone else.

DEVOTIONAL

Feeding Yourself

There is a difference between being fed and learning to cook. This unit hands you the tools.

1 PETER 2:2

"Like newborn babies, crave pure spiritual milk, so that by it you may grow up in your salvation."

Spiritual growth is not automatic; it is fueled. Peter compares Scripture to milk that a growing person craves.

The aim is not to stay dependent on a pastor or parent to feed you, but to learn to feed yourself for a lifetime.

Reflect

1. Are you currently craving God's word, tolerating it, or avoiding it?

2. What would help you develop an appetite for Scripture?

PRAYER PROMPT

God, grow in me a real hunger for your word.

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - OBSERVE

The Bereans' Example

Read the passage slowly, more than once. First notice what it actually says before deciding what it means.

ACTS 17:11

"Now the Berean Jews were of more noble character than those in Thessalonica, for they received the message with great eagerness and examined the Scriptures every day to see if what Paul said was true."

Observation - What does it say?

1. What two things made the Bereans 'noble'?

2. How often did they examine Scripture?

3. What were they checking?

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - INTERPRET & APPLY

The Bereans' Example

Interpretation - What does it mean?

1. Why is it healthy to check even good teaching against the Bible?

2. What is the balance between eagerness and examination?

Application - What will I do?

1. How will you personally examine what you are taught?

2. What does 'daily' realistically look like for you?

WORD STUDY

Meditate

MEANING

In Scripture, to meditate is to chew on and repeat God's word until it shapes your thinking - not to empty your mind, but to fill it.

Where It Appears**PSALM 1:1-2**

"Blessed is the one whose delight is in the law of the Lord, and who meditates on his law day and night."

JOSHUA 1:8

"Keep this Book of the Law always on your lips; meditate on it day and night."

Dig Deeper

1. How is biblical meditation different from popular ideas of meditation?

2. What is one verse you could 'chew on' this week?

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

Practicing the Method

Pick any verse. Write what you observe (what it says).

Now write what you think it means and why.

Finally, write one specific way you will apply it.

APPLICATION CHALLENGE

Try It for a Week

Knowledge you never use fades fast. Put this unit's method into practice.

This Week's Challenges

- ☐ Read one chapter of a Gospel each day for five days.
- ☐ Write one observation, one meaning, and one application each day.
- ☐ Share one thing you learned with someone else.
- ☐ Pray through one passage instead of just reading it.

What happened when you tried?

UNIT 4

The Big Story

"You study the Scriptures... These are the very Scriptures that testify about me." -
John 5:39

Unit Overview

The Bible is not disconnected lessons; it is one story in four movements - Creation, Fall, Redemption, Restoration - all centered on Jesus.

DEVOTIONAL

One Story, Not Sixty-Six

Most people read the Bible like a book of quotes. It is actually one story going somewhere.

LUKE 24:27

"And beginning with Moses and all the Prophets, he explained to them what was said in all the Scriptures concerning himself."

On the road to Emmaus, Jesus showed that the whole Old Testament was pointing to him. The Bible has a main character, and it is not you.

Creation, Fall, Redemption, Restoration: knowing this arc keeps individual verses from feeling random.

Reflect

1. Have you tended to read the Bible as being mainly about you or mainly about God?

2. How does seeing Jesus as the center change a familiar story for you?

PRAYER PROMPT

Jesus, help me see you on every page.

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - OBSERVE

The Story Begins Again

Read the passage slowly, more than once. First notice what it actually says before deciding what it means.

GENESIS 3:8-15

"Then the man and his wife heard the sound of the Lord God as he was walking in the garden in the cool of the day, and they hid from the Lord God among the trees. But the Lord God called to the man, 'Where are you?' ... And I will put enmity between you and the woman, and between your offspring and hers; he will crush your head, and you will strike his heel."

Observation - What does it say?

1. What do the man and woman do when they hear God?

2. What is God's first question to them?

3. What promise is hidden in verse 15?

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - INTERPRET & APPLY

The Story Begins Again

Interpretation - What does it mean?

1. Why does God ask 'Where are you?' if he already knows?

2. How is verse 15 the first hint of the gospel?

Application - What will I do?

1. Where do you tend to hide from God?

2. How does knowing the story ends in rescue change your fear?

WORD STUDY

Redemption

MEANING

To buy back or set free by paying a price. The Bible describes salvation as God redeeming people from sin and death at the cost of Christ.

Where It Appears**EPHESIANS 1:7**

"In him we have redemption through his blood, the forgiveness of sins."

1 CORINTHIANS 6:20

"You were bought at a price. Therefore honor God with your bodies."

Dig Deeper

1. What price was paid for your redemption?

2. If you were 'bought at a price,' how does that change how you see your worth?

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

Finding My Place in the Story

Which part of the story - Creation, Fall, Redemption, Restoration - do you most need to hear right now?

Where do you see brokenness (the Fall) in your own world?

What does the promise of Restoration give you hope for?

FAITH & WORLDVIEW

Why Is There Suffering?

THE QUESTION

If God is good and powerful, why does he allow pain and evil?

Think It Through**The Fall**

The Bible traces suffering to a real break between humanity and God, not to God's cruelty.

A God who enters it

Christianity is unique in claiming God himself suffered on the cross rather than staying distant from pain.

A promised end

Restoration means suffering is temporary, not the final word.

Your Response

1. How is the Christian answer to suffering different from just 'everything happens for a reason'?

2. What suffering in your life do you most want to bring honestly to God?

UNIT 5

From Knowing to Living

"Do not merely listen to the word... Do what it says." - James 1:22

Unit Overview

Information that never becomes action puffs up rather than builds up. This unit is about obedience, character, and letting Scripture reshape daily choices.

DEVOTIONAL

The Danger of Just Knowing

It is possible to know a lot about the Bible and still not follow Jesus. This unit closes that gap.

JAMES 1:22

"Do not merely listen to the word, and so deceive yourselves. Do what it says."

James warns that hearing without doing is a form of self-deception - we feel spiritual without being changed.

The goal of Bible study was never a full head; it was a transformed life.

Reflect

1. Where might you be deceiving yourself - knowing truth you are not living?

2. What is one truth you already know that you need to start obeying?

PRAYER PROMPT

Lord, close the gap between what I know and how I live.

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - OBSERVE

Doers of the Word

Read the passage slowly, more than once. First notice what it actually says before deciding what it means.

JAMES 1:22-25

"Do not merely listen to the word, and so deceive yourselves. Do what it says. Anyone who listens to the word but does not do what it says is like someone who looks at his face in a mirror and, after looking at himself, goes away and immediately forgets what he looks like. But whoever looks intently into the perfect law that gives freedom, and continues in it - not forgetting what they have heard, but doing it - they will be blessed in what they do."

Observation - What does it say?

1. What is the person with the mirror like?

2. What does the blessed person do differently?

3. What is promised to the doer?

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - INTERPRET & APPLY

Doers of the Word

Interpretation - What does it mean?

1. Why does James compare the word to a mirror?

2. What does it mean that God's law 'gives freedom'?

Application - What will I do?

1. What is one thing you 'saw in the mirror' recently and forgot?

2. How will you 'continue in it' this week?

WORD STUDY

Sanctification

MEANING

The lifelong process by which God makes a believer more like Jesus. Not earning salvation, but growing in it.

Where It Appears**1 THESSALONIANS 4:3**

"It is God's will that you should be sanctified."

PHILIPPIANS 1:6

"Being confident of this, that he who began a good work in you will carry it on to completion."

Dig Deeper

1. Why is it freeing that growth is a process, not instant perfection?

2. Where have you seen God change you over the past year?

REFLECTION & JOURNAL**A Life That Matches**

Where is there a gap between what you believe and how you actually live?

What habit would you like God to help you build?

What habit would you like God to help you break?

APPLICATION CHALLENGE

Obedience Experiment

Pick real, measurable steps. Vague goals produce vague lives.

This Week's Challenges

- ☐ Obey one clear command of Scripture this week that you have been avoiding.
- ☐ Apologize to someone you have wronged.
- ☐ Replace 30 minutes of screen time with reading or prayer.
- ☐ Do a good deed no one will ever know about.

What happened when you tried?

UNIT 6

Building a Lasting Faith

"Continue in what you have learned and have become convinced of." - 2 Timothy 3:14

Unit Overview

Many walk away from faith in their late teens. This unit prepares you to own your beliefs, handle doubt, and keep growing when no one is making you.

DEVOTIONAL

A Faith That's Yours

Someday no one will drag you to church or hand you this workbook. Will your faith survive that?

2 TIMOTHY 3:14

"Continue in what you have learned and have become convinced of, because you know those from whom you learned it."

Paul tells Timothy to continue - faith is not a moment but a direction you keep walking.

A borrowed faith cracks under pressure; a personally examined faith holds. Doubts are not the enemy of faith; unexamined doubts are.

Reflect

1. Is your faith currently more inherited or more owned? Be honest.

2. What would help you become 'convinced' rather than just compliant?

PRAYER PROMPT

God, make my faith my own, deep enough to hold under pressure.

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - OBSERVE

Standing Firm

Read the passage slowly, more than once. First notice what it actually says before deciding what it means.

EPHESIANS 6:10-13

"Finally, be strong in the Lord and in his mighty power. Put on the full armor of God, so that you can take your stand against the devil's schemes. For our struggle is not against flesh and blood, but against the rulers, against the authorities, against the powers of this dark world. Therefore put on the full armor of God, so that when the day of evil comes, you may be able to stand your ground."

Observation - What does it say?

1. Whose power are we told to be strong in?

2. Who is the real struggle against?

3. What is the repeated goal of the armor?

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - INTERPRET & APPLY

Standing Firm

Interpretation - What does it mean?

1. Why does it matter that the strength is God's, not ours?

2. What 'schemes' target students your age specifically?

Application - What will I do?

1. Which piece of armor do you most need right now?

2. How will you 'stand your ground' this month?

WORD STUDY

Perseverance

MEANING

Steadfast endurance - continuing to trust and obey God through difficulty, doubt, and time.

Where It Appears**HEBREWS 12:1-2**

"Let us run with perseverance the race marked out for us, fixing our eyes on Jesus."

JAMES 1:12

"Blessed is the one who perseveres under trial."

Dig Deeper

1. What is the difference between perseverance and just gritting your teeth?

2. Who do you know that has persevered in faith, and what can you learn from them?

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

The Road Ahead

What is one belief you want to understand more deeply?

What doubt do you need to stop hiding and start exploring?

Who will you ask to walk with you in your faith going forward?

SMALL GROUP DISCUSSION

Commissioned

This is the last discussion of the book. Talk about the road ahead, not just today.

1. What is the biggest thing you are taking away from this study?

2. What is your plan to keep growing after this workbook ends?

3. How can this group keep each other accountable in the months ahead?

MEMORY & MEDITATION

Hide This Word in Your Heart

2 TIMOTHY 3:16**"2 Timothy 3:16"**

Context

Look back over the verses you studied in this book.

Why It Matters

Scripture memorized becomes a resource the Holy Spirit can bring to mind in real moments of decision, temptation, doubt, and encouragement.

Write It From Memory

LIVE IT OUT THIS WEEK

Choose one verse from this book to carry with you all week.

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

Memory Verse Review

Write out from memory: 2 Timothy 3:16

Write out from memory: Psalm 119:105

Write out from memory: Hebrews 4:12

Write out from memory: James 1:22

Write out from memory: 1 Peter 2:2

SELF-ASSESSMENT

Spiritual Check-In

Rate each statement honestly. This is between you and God - there are no wrong answers, only honest starting points.

1 = rarely 5 = consistently

I make time to read the Bible on my own.

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

I pray about real things in my life, not just at meals.

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

I can explain what I believe and why.

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

I treat people the way Jesus would.

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

I invite God into my decisions before I make them.

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

I am honest even when it costs me.

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

I serve others without expecting anything back.

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

I go to God first when I am anxious or afraid.

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

Final Reflection

What is the most important thing God taught you through this study?

How is your relationship with the Bible different now than when you started?

Write a short prayer committing to keep reading and following God.

NOTES

Study Notes

NOTES

Study Notes



FAITH FOUNDATIONS STUDY SERIES

Bible Stories & Application Study Workbook

Timeless Bible Narratives and What They Mean for Your Life Today -
For Teens & Young Adults

Written by Daniel Tesfamariam



Ages 13-19 - Homeschool & Youth Groups

Personal Study - Small Groups - Reproducible for one household or class



HOW TO USE THIS STUDY

Getting the Most From This Workbook

This study takes six well-known Bible narratives and moves past the flannel-board version you heard as a kid. For ages 13 to 19, each unit asks what the story reveals about God and what it demands of you now. Read, wrestle, journal, and apply.

ROMANS 15:4

"Everything that was written in the past was written to teach us."

A Few Suggestions

- ☐ Find a consistent time and place. Even 15 focused minutes beats an hour you never start.
- ☐ Keep a pen in hand. Writing your answers turns reading into real thinking.
- ☐ Read each passage in your own Bible too, and note the version differences.
- ☐ Be honest in the reflection and journal sections - no one is grading you.
- ☐ If you meet with a group, come having already written your answers.
- ☐ Pray before you begin. Ask God to teach you, not just inform you.

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UNIT 1

Joseph: Trusting God in the Dark

"You intended to harm me, but God intended it for good." - Genesis 50:20

Unit Overview

Joseph was betrayed, enslaved, and imprisoned before he was elevated. His story teaches how God works through injustice we cannot yet understand.

DEVOTIONAL

When Life Isn't Fair

Few teens escape the feeling that life is unfair. Joseph lived it to the extreme - and still trusted God.

GENESIS 50:20

"You intended to harm me, but God intended it for good, to accomplish the saving of many lives."

Joseph does not pretend his brothers were kind; he names the harm. Yet he sees a bigger hand at work behind it.

Trusting God does not mean calling evil good. It means believing God can redeem even what was meant to destroy you.

Reflect

1. What situation feels unfair to you right now?

2. Can you imagine God bringing something good out of it - even if you can't see how yet?

PRAYER PROMPT

God, help me trust you in the parts of my story I don't understand.

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - OBSERVE

Betrayed but Not Abandoned

Read the passage slowly, more than once. First notice what it actually says before deciding what it means.

GENESIS 39:20-23

"Joseph's master took him and put him in prison, the place where the king's prisoners were confined. But while Joseph was there in the prison, the Lord was with him; he showed him kindness and granted him favor in the eyes of the prison warden. So the warden put Joseph in charge of all those held in the prison."

Observation - What does it say?

1. Where is Joseph in this passage?

2. What phrase is repeated about the Lord?

3. What happens even in prison?

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - INTERPRET & APPLY

Betrayed but Not Abandoned

Interpretation - What does it mean?

1. How can God be 'with' someone who is suffering unjustly?

2. What does Joseph's response to prison reveal about his character?

Application - What will I do?

1. Where do you need to remember God is 'with you' right now?

2. How can you act with integrity even in an unfair situation?

WORD STUDY

Providence

MEANING

God's wise, ongoing care that guides all events toward his good purposes, even through human evil and ordinary circumstances.

Where It Appears**ROMANS 8:28**

"In all things God works for the good of those who love him."

PROVERBS 16:4

"The Lord works out everything to its proper end."

Dig Deeper

1. How is providence different from luck or fate?

2. Where have you looked back and seen God's hand in something painful?

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

My Unfair Chapter

Write about a time you were treated unfairly.

How did you respond? How do you wish you had responded?

What would it look like to trust God with that memory now?

FAITH & WORLDVIEW

Does God Cause Evil?

THE QUESTION

If God is in control, is he responsible for the bad things people do?

Think It Through**Human responsibility**

The brothers freely chose to harm Joseph; God did not force their sin.

Divine redemption

God did not author the evil, but he wove it into a plan for good.

Mystery held with trust

The Bible holds both truths without fully explaining the mechanics.

Your Response

1. How does Joseph hold both human evil and God's goodness together?

2. What is the difference between God causing evil and God redeeming it?

UNIT 2

Ruth: Loyalty and Belonging

"Where you go I will go, and where you stay I will stay." - Ruth 1:16

Unit Overview

Ruth, an outsider and a widow, chose loyalty and faith. Her story is about commitment, identity, and how God includes the overlooked.

DEVOTIONAL

Choosing to Stay

Ruth had every reason to walk away and start over. She chose loyalty instead.

RUTH 1:16

"Your people will be my people and your God my God."

Ruth's famous words were not spoken at a wedding but to a grieving mother-in-law with nothing to offer her.

Real commitment shows up when leaving would be easier and no one would blame you for it.

Reflect

1. Where is loyalty hard for you right now?

2. Who in your life needs you to choose to stay?

PRAYER PROMPT

Lord, make me the kind of person who keeps commitments when it costs me.

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - OBSERVE

Faithful in the Fields

Read the passage slowly, more than once. First notice what it actually says before deciding what it means.

RUTH 2:11-12

"Boaz replied, 'I've been told all about what you have done for your mother-in-law since the death of your husband - how you left your father and mother and your homeland and came to live with a people you did not know before. May the Lord repay you for what you have done. May you be richly rewarded by the Lord, the God of Israel, under whose wings you have come to take refuge.'"

Observation - What does it say?

1. What has Boaz heard about Ruth?

2. What did Ruth leave behind?

3. How does Boaz describe God?

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - INTERPRET & APPLY

Faithful in the Fields

Interpretation - What does it mean?

1. Why does Ruth's reputation precede her?

2. What does 'taking refuge under God's wings' mean?

Application - What will I do?

1. What reputation are your actions building?

2. Where do you need to 'take refuge' in God?

WORD STUDY

Kindness (Hesed)

MEANING

The Hebrew word hesed means loyal, covenant love - kindness that keeps its promises and does not quit.

Where It Appears**PROVERBS 3:3**

"Let love and faithfulness never leave you."

PSALM 136:1

"His love (hesed) endures forever."

Dig Deeper

1. How is hesed different from being merely nice?

2. Who has shown you loyal love, and how can you pass it on?

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

Where I Belong


Have you ever felt like an outsider? Describe it.


How does it change things to know God includes the overlooked?


Who around you feels like an outsider that you could welcome?

SMALL GROUP DISCUSSION

Talk It Over

Ruth's story is quiet but powerful. Dig into loyalty and belonging together.

1. What makes loyalty so rare today?

2. Where have you seen God use an 'unlikely' person?

3. How can this group be a place of belonging?

UNIT 3

David and Goliath: Facing Giants

"The battle is the Lord's." - 1 Samuel 17:47

Unit Overview

The famous story is less about a slingshot and more about where our confidence comes from when we face things far bigger than us.

DEVOTIONAL

Naming Your Giants

Everyone faces giants - fears and pressures that feel unbeatable. The question is whose eyes you use to size them up.

1 SAMUEL 17:37

"The Lord who rescued me from the paw of the lion and the paw of the bear will rescue me from the hand of this Philistine."

David's courage came from memory: he recalled past rescues to face a present threat.

Everyone else measured Goliath against themselves. David measured Goliath against God.

Reflect

1. What 'giant' feels unbeatable to you right now?

2. What past faithfulness of God can you remember to build courage?

PRAYER PROMPT

God, help me see my giants next to you, not next to me.

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - OBSERVE

Confidence in the Lord

Read the passage slowly, more than once. First notice what it actually says before deciding what it means.

1 SAMUEL 17:45-47

"David said to the Philistine, 'You come against me with sword and spear and javelin, but I come against you in the name of the Lord Almighty, the God of the armies of Israel, whom you have defied. This day the Lord will deliver you into my hands... All those gathered here will know that it is not by sword or spear that the Lord saves; for the battle is the Lord's.'"

Observation - What does it say?

1. What weapons does Goliath rely on?

2. What does David come in the name of?

3. Whose battle is it?

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - INTERPRET & APPLY

Confidence in the Lord

Interpretation - What does it mean?

1. Why does David make it about God's reputation, not his own?

2. What does 'the battle is the Lord's' mean practically?

Application - What will I do?

1. What are you trying to win in your own strength?

2. How would today change if you saw the battle as God's?

WORD STUDY

Courage

MEANING

Not the absence of fear, but acting rightly in spite of fear because of confidence in God.

Where It Appears

DEUTERONOMY 31:6

"Be strong and courageous. Do not be afraid; the Lord your God goes with you."

JOSHUA 1:9

"Have I not commanded you? Be strong and courageous."

Dig Deeper

1. How is biblical courage different from being fearless?

2. What is one courageous, God-honoring step you have been avoiding?

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

My Giants

List the 'giants' you are currently facing.

Which one scares you most, and why?

What would it look like to face it trusting God?

APPLICATION CHALLENGE

Face One Giant

Courage grows by use. Take one real step this week.

This Week's Challenges

- ☐ Have one hard conversation you have been avoiding.
- ☐ Do one right thing that will cost you socially.
- ☐ Pray specifically about your biggest fear every day this week.
- ☐ Ask a trusted adult for help with something you can't face alone.

What happened when you tried?

UNIT 4

The Prodigal Son: Coming Home

"This son of mine was dead and is alive again." - Luke 15:24

Unit Overview

Jesus' most famous parable is about running away, hitting bottom, and a father who runs to welcome us back. It reframes how we see God.

DEVOTIONAL

The Father Who Runs

Whether you feel like the wild younger son or the resentful older one, this story is about you.

LUKE 15:20

"But while he was still a long way off, his father saw him and was filled with compassion for him; he ran to his son."

In that culture, dignified men did not run. The father's running was scandalous grace.

The son rehearsed a speech to earn his way back; the father interrupted it with a robe and a ring. Grace is not earned.

Reflect

1. Do you relate more to the younger son or the older brother right now?

2. What do you think you have to do to earn God's acceptance?

PRAYER PROMPT

Father, thank you that you run toward me. Help me come home.

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - OBSERVE

Lost and Found

Read the passage slowly, more than once. First notice what it actually says before deciding what it means.

LUKE 15:17-24

"When he came to his senses, he said, 'How many of my father's hired servants have food to spare, and here I am starving to death! I will set out and go back to my father.' ... But the father said to his servants, 'Quick! Bring the best robe and put it on him. Put a ring on his finger and sandals on his feet. Let's have a feast and celebrate. For this son of mine was dead and is alive again; he was lost and is found.'"

Observation - What does it say?

1. What causes the son to change direction?

2. What does he plan to say?

3. How does the father respond before the son can finish?

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - INTERPRET & APPLY

Lost and Found

Interpretation - What does it mean?

1. What does 'coming to his senses' mean spiritually?

2. Why does the father celebrate instead of lecture?

Application - What will I do?

1. What would 'coming to your senses' look like for you?

2. What do you need to stop trying to earn?

WORD STUDY

Grace

MEANING

Undeserved favor - God's kindness given freely to people who could never earn it.

Where It Appears**EPHESIANS 2:8**

"For it is by grace you have been saved, through faith."

ROMANS 5:20

"Where sin increased, grace increased all the more."

Dig Deeper

1. Why is grace so hard for us to accept?

2. How does receiving grace change how you treat others?

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

Coming Home

Is there an area where you have wandered from God?

What holds you back from coming home to him?

Write the 'father running toward you' in your own words.

FAITH & WORLDVIEW

Isn't Christianity Just a Crutch?

THE QUESTION

Is faith only for weak people who can't cope on their own?

Think It Through**Everyone leans on something**

Money, status, and relationships are also 'crutches' people trust for meaning.

Honesty about need

Christianity starts by admitting we all need help - that is realism, not weakness.

Strength to serve

Faith has driven believers to hospitals, abolition, and sacrifice, not just comfort.

Your Response

1. What do people around you lean on for meaning?

2. How would you respond to a friend who calls faith a crutch?

UNIT 5

Esther: Courage for Such a Time

"And who knows but that you have come to your royal position for such a time as this?" - Esther 4:14

Unit Overview

Esther risked her life to speak up for her people. Her story is about using your position, however small, for good at the right moment.

DEVOTIONAL

For Such a Time as This

You did not end up in your family, school, or friend group by accident. God places people on purpose.

ESTHER 4:14

"If you remain silent at this time, relief and deliverance for the Jews will arise from another place... And who knows but that you have come to your royal position for such a time as this?"

Esther could have stayed safe and silent. Mordecai reminds her that safety is not the same as purpose.

God does not need you - but he chooses to use you. That is dignity, not pressure.

Reflect

1. Where has God placed you that others cannot easily reach?

2. Is there something you have stayed silent about that you should speak up on?

PRAYER PROMPT

God, give me courage to use where you have placed me for good.

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - OBSERVE

Risking It All

Read the passage slowly, more than once. First notice what it actually says before deciding what it means.

ESTHER 4:15-17

"Then Esther sent this reply to Mordecai: 'Go, gather together all the Jews who are in Susa, and fast for me. Do not eat or drink for three days, night or day. I and my attendants will fast as you do. When this is done, I will go to the king, even though it is against the law. And if I perish, I perish.'"

Observation - What does it say?

1. What does Esther ask others to do first?

2. What law is she about to break?

3. What is her final resolve?

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - INTERPRET & APPLY

Risking It All

Interpretation - What does it mean?

1. Why does Esther call for fasting before acting?

2. What does 'if I perish, I perish' reveal about her?

Application - What will I do?

1. What do you need to pray and fast about before you act?

2. Where do you need Esther-level resolve?

WORD STUDY

Providence

MEANING

God's unseen guidance of events. God is never named in Esther, yet his hand is on every 'coincidence.'

Where It Appears**PROVERBS 21:1**

"The king's heart is in the hand of the Lord."

PROVERBS 19:21

"Many are the plans in a person's heart, but it is the Lord's purpose that prevails."

Dig Deeper

1. Why might God be at work even when he seems 'absent'?

2. Where have you seen 'coincidences' that were maybe more than that?

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

My Position, My Moment


What influence do you have that you tend to overlook?


Is there a right thing you have been too scared to do?


What would courage look like this week?

SMALL GROUP DISCUSSION

Talk It Over

Esther's story pushes us from safety to purpose. Discuss honestly.

1. Where do we stay silent when we should speak?

2. How do we tell the difference between wise caution and fear?

3. How can this group support each other in doing hard, right things?

UNIT 6

Jesus: The Story's Center

"I am the way and the truth and the life." - John 14:6

Unit Overview

Every earlier story points here. This unit looks at who Jesus claimed to be and what it means to follow him, not just admire him.

DEVOTIONAL

More Than a Good Teacher

Most people are happy to call Jesus a good teacher. His own claims make that a hard place to stop.

JOHN 14:6

"I am the way and the truth and the life. No one comes to the Father except through me."

A merely good teacher does not claim to be the only way to God. Jesus repeatedly did.

That leaves fewer options than we like: he was either lying, deluded, or telling the truth. 'Nice teacher' isn't really on the menu.

Reflect

1. Who have you tended to believe Jesus is?

2. What would change if his claims about himself are actually true?

PRAYER PROMPT

Jesus, show me who you really are, and help me follow, not just admire, you.

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - OBSERVE

The Great Invitation

Read the passage slowly, more than once. First notice what it actually says before deciding what it means.

MATTHEW 11:28-30

"Come to me, all you who are weary and burdened, and I will give you rest. Take my yoke upon you and learn from me, for I am gentle and humble in heart, and you will find rest for your souls. For my yoke is easy and my burden is light."

Observation - What does it say?

1. Who is invited to come?

2. What does Jesus promise to give?

3. How does he describe himself?

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - INTERPRET & APPLY

The Great Invitation

Interpretation - What does it mean?

1. What is a 'yoke,' and why is following Jesus described that way?

2. How can a yoke bring rest?

Application - What will I do?

1. What are you weary and burdened by right now?

2. What would it look like to bring that to Jesus this week?

WORD STUDY

Disciple

MEANING

A learner and follower who orders their whole life around a teacher. To follow Jesus is to become his apprentice.

Where It Appears**JOHN 8:31**

"If you hold to my teaching, you are really my disciples."

MATTHEW 28:19

"Go and make disciples of all nations."

Dig Deeper

1. What is the difference between a fan and a disciple?

2. What area of your life have you not yet let Jesus 'teach'?

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

Following, Not Just Admiring

Where have you kept Jesus as an admired figure rather than a followed Lord?

What would fully following him cost you?

What is one step of real discipleship you will take?

APPLICATION CHALLENGE

Follow This Week

Discipleship is practiced, not just believed. Choose concrete steps.

This Week's Challenges

- ☐ Read one Gospel account of Jesus each day this week.
- ☐ Do one thing Jesus commands that stretches you.
- ☐ Tell one person something true about who Jesus is.
- ☐ Bring one real burden to Jesus in prayer each day.

What happened when you tried?

MEMORY & MEDITATION

Hide This Word in Your Heart

GENESIS 50:20

"Genesis 50:20"

Context

Look back over the verses you studied in this book.

Why It Matters

Scripture memorized becomes a resource the Holy Spirit can bring to mind in real moments of decision, temptation, doubt, and encouragement.

Write It From Memory

LIVE IT OUT THIS WEEK

Choose one verse from this book to carry with you all week.

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

Memory Verse Review

Write out from memory: Genesis 50:20

Write out from memory: Ruth 1:16

Write out from memory: 1 Samuel 17:47

Write out from memory: Luke 15:24

Write out from memory: John 14:6

SELF-ASSESSMENT

Spiritual Check-In

Rate each statement honestly. This is between you and God - there are no wrong answers, only honest starting points.

1 = rarely 5 = consistently

I make time to read the Bible on my own.

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

I pray about real things in my life, not just at meals.

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

I can explain what I believe and why.

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

I treat people the way Jesus would.

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

I invite God into my decisions before I make them.

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

I am honest even when it costs me.

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

I serve others without expecting anything back.

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

I go to God first when I am anxious or afraid.

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

Final Reflection

Which Bible story spoke to you most, and why?

How has your view of God changed through these stories?

Write a prayer response to what you've learned.

NOTES

Study Notes

NOTES

Study Notes



FAITH FOUNDATIONS STUDY SERIES

Faith, Kindness & Courage Study Workbook

Building Christlike Character for Real Teenage Pressures - A Study for
Ages 13-19

Written by Daniel Tesfamariam



Ages 13-19 - Homeschool & Youth Groups

Personal Study - Small Groups - Reproducible for one household or class

HOW TO USE THIS STUDY

Getting the Most From This Workbook

Being a teenager means constant pressure - to fit in, stay quiet, and go along. This six-unit study builds three anchors of Christlike character: faith that holds when you can't see, kindness that costs something, and courage that stands firm. Expect honesty, Scripture, and real application.

HEBREWS 12:1

"Let us run with perseverance the race marked out for us."

A Few Suggestions

- ☐ Find a consistent time and place. Even 15 focused minutes beats an hour you never start.
- ☐ Keep a pen in hand. Writing your answers turns reading into real thinking.
- ☐ Read each passage in your own Bible too, and note the version differences.
- ☐ Be honest in the reflection and journal sections - no one is grading you.
- ☐ If you meet with a group, come having already written your answers.
- ☐ Pray before you begin. Ask God to teach you, not just inform you.

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UNIT 1

Faith When You Can't See

"Faith is confidence in what we hope for and assurance about what we do not see."

- Hebrews 11:1

Unit Overview

Faith is not blind or irrational; it is trust based on who God has proven to be. This unit defines real faith and separates it from wishful thinking.

DEVOTIONAL

Trust Isn't Blind

People treat faith like crossing your fingers and hoping. The Bible describes it very differently.

HEBREWS 11:1

"Now faith is confidence in what we hope for and assurance about what we do not see."

Biblical faith is confidence based on evidence and relationship, not a leap into the dark. You trust a friend you know; you trust God the same way.

Doubt is not the opposite of faith - refusal to trust is. Honest doubt, brought to God, often deepens faith.

Reflect

1. What do you think most people mean by 'faith'? How is the Bible's definition different?

2. Where do you find it hardest to trust God right now?

PRAYER PROMPT

God, grow real, evidence-based trust in me, especially where I can't see.

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - OBSERVE

The Hall of Faith

Read the passage slowly, more than once. First notice what it actually says before deciding what it means.

HEBREWS 11:6-8

"And without faith it is impossible to please God, because anyone who comes to him must believe that he exists and that he rewards those who earnestly seek him. By faith Noah, when warned about things not yet seen, in holy fear built an ark to save his family. By faith Abraham, when called to go to a place he would later receive as his inheritance, obeyed and went, even though he did not know where he was going."

Observation - What does it say?

1. What two things must someone believe to come to God?

2. What did Noah do by faith?

3. What did Abraham not know?

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - INTERPRET & APPLY

The Hall of Faith

Interpretation - What does it mean?

1. Why does obedience often come before understanding?

2. How is faith connected to action here?

Application - What will I do?

1. Where is God asking you to obey before you fully understand?

2. What 'ark' or step of faith is in front of you?

WORD STUDY

Faith

MEANING

Trust and reliance on God - believing he is who he says and acting on it.

Where It Appears**2 CORINTHIANS 5:7**

"We live by faith, not by sight."

ROMANS 10:17

"Faith comes from hearing the message, through the word about Christ."

Dig Deeper

1. If faith comes from hearing God's word, how should that shape your habits?

2. What is the difference between believing about God and trusting God?

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

My Faith, Honestly


Rate your trust in God right now and explain why.


What doubt have you been afraid to admit?


What would help your faith grow?

FAITH & WORLDVIEW

Faith vs. Science?

THE QUESTION

Do you have to choose between believing in God and accepting science?

Think It Through**Different questions**

Science asks how the universe works; faith asks why it exists and what it means.

Believing scientists

Many leading scientists across history have been people of faith.

Not blind

Christian faith invites investigation; it is not threatened by honest questions.

Your Response

1. Have you felt pressure to choose between faith and science? Describe it.

2. What question about faith and science do you most want answered?

UNIT 2

Kindness That Costs Something

"Be kind and compassionate to one another." - Ephesians 4:32

Unit Overview

Real kindness is more than being nice; it is choosing others' good even when it's inconvenient. This unit explores compassion, generosity, and forgiveness.

DEVOTIONAL

More Than Being Nice

Nice avoids conflict. Kindness moves toward people, sometimes into discomfort, for their good.

EPHESIANS 4:32

"Be kind and compassionate to one another, forgiving each other, just as in Christ God forgave you."

Notice kindness is tied to forgiveness here - the hardest kind, extended to people who hurt us.

The model is not our mood but the cross: 'just as God forgave you.' Kindness flows from grace received.

Reflect

1. Who is hard for you to be kind to right now?

2. How does remembering God's forgiveness of you change that?

PRAYER PROMPT

Lord, make me kind the way you are kind - even when it costs me.

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - OBSERVE

The Good Samaritan

Read the passage slowly, more than once. First notice what it actually says before deciding what it means.

LUKE 10:33-37

"But a Samaritan, as he traveled, came where the man was; and when he saw him, he took pity on him. He went to him and bandaged his wounds, pouring on oil and wine. Then he put the man on his own donkey, brought him to an inn and took care of him. The next day he took out two denarii and gave them to the innkeeper. 'Look after him,' he said, 'and when I return, I will reimburse you for any extra expense.'"

Observation - What does it say?

1. What does the Samaritan do when he sees the man?

2. List everything it cost him.

3. Who was the Samaritan to the Jews of that day?

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - INTERPRET & APPLY

The Good Samaritan

Interpretation - What does it mean?

1. Why does Jesus make the hero someone his audience despised?

2. What does this teach about who our 'neighbor' is?

Application - What will I do?

1. Who is a 'neighbor' you have walked past?

2. What would costly kindness look like this week?

WORD STUDY

Compassion

MEANING

To be moved deeply by another's suffering - literally, to 'suffer with' - and to act on it.

Where It Appears**PSALM 145:8**

"The Lord is gracious and compassionate, slow to anger."

COLOSSIANS 3:12

"Clothe yourselves with compassion, kindness, humility."

Dig Deeper

1. What is the difference between pity and compassion?

2. Whose suffering are you tempted to ignore?

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

Acts of Real Kindness

When has someone's kindness changed a hard day for you?

Who around you is hurting and easy to overlook?

What is one costly, quiet kindness you could do?

APPLICATION CHALLENGE

Kindness on Purpose

Kindness rarely happens by accident. Plan it.

This Week's Challenges

- ☐ Do a kind act for someone who cannot repay you.
- ☐ Forgive someone - at least in your own heart - this week.
- ☐ Include someone who is usually left out.
- ☐ Encourage someone specifically, not generically.

What happened when you tried?

UNIT 3

Courage Under Pressure

"Be on your guard; stand firm in the faith; be courageous; be strong." - 1 Corinthians 16:13

Unit Overview

Teens face intense pressure to conform. This unit studies standing firm with courage, drawing on Daniel and his friends.

DEVOTIONAL

Standing Alone

Sooner or later everyone faces the choice to go along with the crowd or stand on conviction.

DANIEL 3:18

"But even if he does not, we want you to know, Your Majesty, that we will not serve your gods."

Daniel's friends trusted God to rescue them - but decided to obey even if he didn't. That is mature courage.

Courage is not certainty of the outcome; it is faithfulness regardless of it.

Reflect

1. Where do you feel pressure to compromise your convictions?

2. Could you say 'but even if he does not' and still obey?

PRAYER PROMPT

God, give me courage to stand even when it's costly and lonely.

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - OBSERVE

The Fiery Furnace

Read the passage slowly, more than once. First notice what it actually says before deciding what it means.

DANIEL 3:16-18

"Shadrach, Meshach and Abednego replied to him, 'King Nebuchadnezzar, we do not need to defend ourselves before you in this matter. If we are thrown into the blazing furnace, the God we serve is able to deliver us from it, and he will deliver us from Your Majesty's hand. But even if he does not, we want you to know, Your Majesty, that we will not serve your gods or worship the image of gold you have set up.'"

Observation - What does it say?

1. What choice are the three men facing?

2. What do they believe God is able to do?

3. What is their decision if he doesn't?

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - INTERPRET & APPLY

The Fiery Furnace

Interpretation - What does it mean?

1. Why is 'but even if he does not' so important?

2. How do they balance faith and realism?

Application - What will I do?

1. What 'furnace' might your convictions cost you?

2. Where do you need this kind of resolve?

WORD STUDY

Conviction

MEANING

A settled belief you will act on even under pressure - the backbone of courageous character.

Where It Appears**PSALM 1:1**

"Blessed is the one who does not walk in step with the wicked."

ROMANS 12:2

"Do not conform to the pattern of this world, but be transformed."

Dig Deeper

1. What convictions have you actually decided in advance?

2. How do people without settled convictions tend to make decisions?

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

My Pressure Points


Where do you feel the most pressure to conform?


What conviction do you want to settle before you're tested?


Who stands with you, and who could?

SMALL GROUP DISCUSSION

Talk It Over

Standing firm is easier together. Be real about the pressures you face.

- 1.** What pressures do people our age face that adults underestimate?

- 2.** When have you stood firm - or wished you had?

- 3.** How can this group have each other's backs?

UNIT 4

Faith That Endures Doubt

"I do believe; help me overcome my unbelief!" - Mark 9:24

Unit Overview

Doubt is normal and not the end of faith. This unit teaches how to bring doubt to God honestly and let it deepen rather than destroy belief.

DEVOTIONAL

Honest Doubt

Some of the most faithful people in the Bible had serious doubts - and God did not reject them for it.

MARK 9:24

"Immediately the boy's father exclaimed, 'I do believe; help me overcome my unbelief!'"

This father does not hide his mixed heart; he brings both his faith and his doubt to Jesus. And Jesus responds.

You do not have to choose between faith and honesty. Bring the doubt to God, not around him.

Reflect

1. What doubts have you felt you had to hide?

2. How would it feel to bring them honestly to God?

PRAYER PROMPT

Jesus, I believe; help my unbelief. Meet me in my questions.

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - OBSERVE

Thomas and Evidence

Read the passage slowly, more than once. First notice what it actually says before deciding what it means.

JOHN 20:27-29

"Then he said to Thomas, 'Put your finger here; see my hands. Reach out your hand and put it into my side. Stop doubting and believe.' Thomas said to him, 'My Lord and my God!' Then Jesus told him, 'Because you have seen me, you have believed; blessed are those who have not seen and yet have believed.'"

Observation - What does it say?

1. What does Jesus offer Thomas?

2. How does Thomas respond?

3. Who does Jesus call blessed?

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - INTERPRET & APPLY

Thomas and Evidence

Interpretation - What does it mean?

1. Why might Jesus meet Thomas's doubt with evidence rather than rebuke?

2. What does this say about honest questions?

Application - What will I do?

1. What evidence has God given you to trust him?

2. What doubt do you need to bring into the light?

WORD STUDY

Assurance

MEANING

A settled confidence in God's promises, grounded in his character and work, not in our feelings.

Where It Appears**ROMANS 8:28**

"We know that in all things God works for the good of those who love him."

2 TIMOTHY 1:12

"I know whom I have believed, and am convinced that he is able."

Dig Deeper

1. What is the difference between feelings and assurance?

2. How can you build assurance in seasons you don't 'feel' God?

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

My Questions


Write your three biggest questions about faith.


Who could help you explore them honestly?


What would it look like to keep trusting while you search?

FAITH & WORLDVIEW

What About Other Religions?

THE QUESTION

How can Christians claim to be right when so many religions disagree?

Think It Through**Not all the same**

Religions make genuinely different, often contradictory claims - they can't all be equally true.

A person, not just a system

Christianity centers on a historical person who claimed and demonstrated authority.

Humble confidence

Believing something is true doesn't require arrogance toward those who differ.

Your Response

1. How would you kindly talk about faith with a friend of another religion?

2. What question about other religions do you still have?

UNIT 5

Courageous Kindness in Action

"Let us not love with words or speech but with actions and in truth." - 1 John 3:18

Unit Overview

This unit fuses the three themes: faith gives roots, kindness gives direction, courage gives follow-through. Together they form Christlike character.

DEVOTIONAL

Love With Skin On

Faith, kindness, and courage are not separate virtues; they meet whenever you do a hard, loving thing.

1 JOHN 3:18

"Dear children, let us not love with words or speech but with actions and in truth."

It is easy to post about love and hard to practice it. John pushes us from talk to action.

Courageous kindness - standing up for someone, serving quietly, telling the truth in love - is faith made visible.

Reflect

1. Where has your love been mostly words lately?

2. What action would make it real?

PRAYER PROMPT

God, turn my faith into love that people can actually see and feel.

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - OBSERVE

Faith Expressed in Love

Read the passage slowly, more than once. First notice what it actually says before deciding what it means.

GALATIANS 5:6B, 13-14

"The only thing that counts is faith expressing itself through love... You, my brothers and sisters, were called to be free. But do not use your freedom to indulge the flesh; rather, serve one another humbly in love. For the entire law is fulfilled in keeping this one command: 'Love your neighbor as yourself.'"

Observation - What does it say?

1. How is genuine faith expressed?

2. What are we told not to do with freedom?

3. What sums up the whole law?

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - INTERPRET & APPLY

Faith Expressed in Love

Interpretation - What does it mean?

1. Why does Paul link faith and love so tightly?

2. How is serving others a use of freedom, not a loss of it?

Application - What will I do?

1. Who has God put near you to serve?

2. What would loving your neighbor look like this week?

WORD STUDY

Integrity

MEANING

Being the same person in private and public - whole and undivided in character.

Where It Appears

PSALM 15:2-4

"The one whose walk is blameless... who keeps an oath even when it hurts."

PROVERBS 10:9

"Whoever walks in integrity walks securely."

Dig Deeper

1. Where is it tempting to be a different person online than in person?

2. What does 'keeping an oath even when it hurts' cost?

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

The Person I'm Becoming

Which do you most need to grow in: faith, kindness, or courage? Why?

Describe the kind of person you want to be at 25.

What is one habit that would move you toward that person?

APPLICATION CHALLENGE

All Three, One Week

Put faith, kindness, and courage into a single week of practice.

This Week's Challenges

- ☐ Faith: start each day with one honest prayer.
- ☐ Kindness: do one costly kind act.
- ☐ Courage: do one right thing you're afraid to do.
- ☐ Integrity: make your private life match your public words once where it's slipping.

What happened when you tried?

UNIT 6

A Character That Lasts

"The fruit of the Spirit is love, joy, peace, patience, kindness, goodness, faithfulness, gentleness and self-control." - Galatians 5:22-23

Unit Overview

Character is not built in a day; it is grown by the Spirit over time. This unit looks at the fruit of the Spirit as the long-term goal.

DEVOTIONAL

Fruit, Not Fireworks

Fireworks are impressive and gone in seconds. Fruit grows slowly and feeds people. Character is fruit.

GALATIANS 5:22-23

"But the fruit of the Spirit is love, joy, peace, patience, kindness, goodness, faithfulness, gentleness and self-control."

Notice it is 'fruit,' not 'achievements.' You do not manufacture character; you grow it as you stay connected to God.

You cannot force fruit, but you can tend the conditions: staying close to Jesus, obeying in small things, and giving it time.

Reflect

1. Which fruit is most evident in your life? Which is least?

2. What 'conditions' in your life help or hurt your growth?

PRAYER PROMPT

Holy Spirit, grow lasting fruit in me. I want to be tended, not just impressive.

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - OBSERVE

Remaining in the Vine

Read the passage slowly, more than once. First notice what it actually says before deciding what it means.

JOHN 15:4-5

"Remain in me, as I also remain in you. No branch can bear fruit by itself; it must remain in the vine. Neither can you bear fruit unless you remain in me. I am the vine; you are the branches. If you remain in me and I in you, you will bear much fruit; apart from me you can do nothing."

Observation - What does it say?

1. What must a branch do to bear fruit?

2. What is the vine? The branches?

3. What can we do apart from Jesus?

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - INTERPRET & APPLY

Remaining in the Vine

Interpretation - What does it mean?

1. What does 'remain in me' practically involve?

2. Why is fruit impossible on our own?

Application - What will I do?

1. What helps you 'remain' in Jesus day to day?

2. What disconnects you, and how will you address it?

WORD STUDY

Self-Control

MEANING

The Spirit-empowered ability to govern your desires rather than be ruled by them.

Where It Appears**PROVERBS 25:28**

"Like a city whose walls are broken through is a person who lacks self-control."

2 TIMOTHY 1:7

"God gave us a spirit not of fear but of power, love and self-control."

Dig Deeper

1. Where do you most lack self-control right now?

2. How is self-control a gift from the Spirit rather than pure willpower?

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

Growing Season


Which fruit do you most want God to grow in you this year?


What have you learned about yourself in this study?


Write a prayer for lasting character.

SMALL GROUP DISCUSSION

Commissioned

The last discussion. Look ahead at the character you're building.

1. Which of faith, kindness, or courage will be hardest to keep practicing?

2. What is your plan to keep growing after this book?

3. How can this group keep encouraging each other's character?

MEMORY & MEDITATION

Hide This Word in Your Heart

HEBREWS 11:1

"Hebrews 11:1"

Context

Look back over the verses you studied in this book.

Why It Matters

Scripture memorized becomes a resource the Holy Spirit can bring to mind in real moments of decision, temptation, doubt, and encouragement.

Write It From Memory

LIVE IT OUT THIS WEEK

Choose one verse from this book to carry with you all week.

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

Memory Verse Review

Write out from memory: Hebrews 11:1

Write out from memory: Ephesians 4:32

Write out from memory: 1 Corinthians 16:13

Write out from memory: 1 John 3:18

Write out from memory: Galatians 5:22-23

SELF-ASSESSMENT

Spiritual Check-In

Rate each statement honestly. This is between you and God - there are no wrong answers, only honest starting points.

1 = rarely 5 = consistently

I make time to read the Bible on my own.

(1) (2) (3) (4) (5)

I pray about real things in my life, not just at meals.

(1) (2) (3) (4) (5)

I can explain what I believe and why.

(1) (2) (3) (4) (5)

I treat people the way Jesus would.

(1) (2) (3) (4) (5)

I invite God into my decisions before I make them.

(1) (2) (3) (4) (5)

I am honest even when it costs me.

(1) (2) (3) (4) (5)

I serve others without expecting anything back.

(1) (2) (3) (4) (5)

I go to God first when I am anxious or afraid.

(1) (2) (3) (4) (5)

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

Final Reflection


Which theme - faith, kindness, or courage - do you most want to carry forward?


How has your character been challenged and shaped in this study?


Write a prayer about the person God is growing you to be.

NOTES

Study Notes

NOTES

Study Notes



FAITH FOUNDATIONS STUDY SERIES

Foundations of Faith: A Study Workbook

The Core Truths Every Young Christian Should Own - A First Serious Study for Ages 13-19

Written by Daniel Tesfamariam



Ages 13-19 - Homeschool & Youth Groups

Personal Study - Small Groups - Reproducible for one household or class

HOW TO USE THIS STUDY

Getting the Most From This Workbook

Maybe you grew up in church, or maybe this is all new. Either way, this study lays the foundation: who God is, who you are, what went wrong, how Jesus rescues, and how to live it out. It's called 'Foundations' because everything else you believe is built on these six units. For ages 13 to 19.

1 CORINTHIANS 3:11

"No one can lay any foundation other than the one already laid, which is Jesus Christ."

A Few Suggestions

- ☐ Find a consistent time and place. Even 15 focused minutes beats an hour you never start.
- ☐ Keep a pen in hand. Writing your answers turns reading into real thinking.
- ☐ Read each passage in your own Bible too, and note the version differences.
- ☐ Be honest in the reflection and journal sections - no one is grading you.
- ☐ If you meet with a group, come having already written your answers.
- ☐ Pray before you begin. Ask God to teach you, not just inform you.

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UNIT 1

Who Is God?

"In the beginning God created the heavens and the earth." - Genesis 1:1

Unit Overview

Everything starts with God. This unit explores his character - holy, loving, powerful, personal - as the foundation for everything else you believe.

DEVOTIONAL

Starting With God

If you get God wrong, everything else bends around the mistake. So we start here.

GENESIS 1:1

"In the beginning God created the heavens and the earth."

The Bible does not argue for God's existence; it assumes it and shows his character in action.

God is both transcendent (far above us) and personal (near to us). Holding both keeps faith honest and warm.

Reflect

1. What picture of God did you grow up with? Is it accurate?

2. Which of God's qualities do you most need to know is true right now?

PRAYER PROMPT

God, help me know you as you really are, not as I've assumed.

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - OBSERVE

God Reveals Himself

Read the passage slowly, more than once. First notice what it actually says before deciding what it means.

EXODUS 34:6-7

"And he passed in front of Moses, proclaiming, 'The Lord, the Lord, the compassionate and gracious God, slow to anger, abounding in love and faithfulness, maintaining love to thousands, and forgiving wickedness, rebellion and sin. Yet he does not leave the guilty unpunished.'"

Observation - What does it say?

1. List every quality God names about himself here.

2. What is God 'slow to' and 'abounding in'?

3. What does God not do?

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - INTERPRET & APPLY

God Reveals Himself

Interpretation - What does it mean?

1. How do God's mercy and justice fit together?

2. Why does it matter that God describes himself rather than us guessing?

Application - What will I do?

1. Which quality of God challenges you most?

2. How does knowing God's character change how you approach him?

WORD STUDY

Holy

MEANING

Set apart, pure, wholly other. God's holiness means he is perfect and distinct from all creation.

Where It Appears**ISAIAH 6:3**

"Holy, holy, holy is the Lord Almighty; the whole earth is full of his glory."

1 PETER 1:16

"Be holy, because I am holy."

Dig Deeper

1. Why is God's holiness both awe-inspiring and comforting?

2. What would it mean for your life to be 'set apart'?

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

My Picture of God

Describe how you honestly picture God.

Where might that picture be off?

What quality of God do you want to know better?

FAITH & WORLDVIEW

Does God Even Exist?

THE QUESTION

Is there good reason to believe God is real?

Think It Through**Something from nothing**

The universe had a beginning; a beginning points to a cause beyond itself.

Design and order

The fine-tuned conditions for life invite the question of a designer.

Moral sense

Our deep sense that some things are truly wrong points beyond mere opinion.

Your Response

1. Which reason resonates with you most?

2. What honest question about God's existence do you still carry?

UNIT 2

Who Am I?

"So God created mankind in his own image." - Genesis 1:27

Unit Overview

Identity is the biggest battle of the teen years. This unit anchors your worth not in performance or approval but in being made and loved by God.

DEVOTIONAL

Made in His Image

You are surrounded by voices telling you your worth is your looks, grades, or followers. God says something different.

GENESIS 1:27

"So God created mankind in his own image, in the image of God he created them."

Your value is not earned or ranked; it is assigned by your Maker. You bear God's image before you achieve anything.

That means your worth cannot be increased by success or destroyed by failure. It is a gift, not a score.

Reflect

1. Where do you tend to look for your worth?

2. How would believing you're made in God's image change a hard day?

PRAYER PROMPT

God, help me find my identity in you, not in performance or approval.

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - OBSERVE

Known and Formed

Read the passage slowly, more than once. First notice what it actually says before deciding what it means.

PSALM 139:13-16

"For you created my inmost being; you knit me together in my mother's womb. I praise you because I am fearfully and wonderfully made; your works are wonderful, I know that full well. My frame was not hidden from you when I was made in the secret place... your eyes saw my unformed body. All the days ordained for me were written in your book before one of them came to be."

Observation - What does it say?

1. What did God do before you were born?

2. How does the writer describe himself?

3. What did God know about your days?

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - INTERPRET & APPLY

Known and Formed

Interpretation - What does it mean?

1. What does 'fearfully and wonderfully made' mean for how you see yourself?

2. How does being 'known' comfort and challenge you?

Application - What will I do?

1. What do you criticize about yourself that God calls 'wonderfully made'?

2. How can you speak to yourself differently this week?

WORD STUDY

Image of God (Imago Dei)

MEANING

The truth that every human uniquely reflects God, giving all people inherent dignity and worth.

Where It Appears**PSALM 8:5**

"You made them a little lower than the angels and crowned them with glory."

JAMES 3:9

"With the tongue we... curse human beings, who have been made in God's likeness."

Dig Deeper

1. If everyone bears God's image, how should you treat people you dislike?

2. How does this truth confront racism, bullying, and cruelty?

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

Who I Really Am

List the labels others (or you) put on you.

What does God say is true about you?

Which of God's truths do you most need to believe?

SMALL GROUP DISCUSSION

Talk It Over

Identity is a shared struggle. Be honest about the pressures.

1. Where do people our age get their sense of worth?

2. How does social media shape identity - for better or worse?

3. How can this group speak truth over each other's labels?

UNIT 3

What Went Wrong?

"For all have sinned and fall short of the glory of God." - Romans 3:23

Unit Overview

If God and people are good, why is the world such a mess? This unit honestly faces sin - what it is, why it matters, and why we can't fix it ourselves.

DEVOTIONAL

Naming the Problem

You don't have to be told the world is broken; you feel it. The Bible names the reason without flinching.

ROMANS 3:23

"For all have sinned and fall short of the glory of God."

Sin is not just breaking rules; it is a broken relationship - living as though we, not God, are the center.

Admitting the problem is not depressing; it's the first honest step toward a real solution.

Reflect

1. Where do you see brokenness in the world and in yourself?

2. Why is it hard to admit we can't fix ourselves?

PRAYER PROMPT

God, give me honesty about my sin and hope in your solution.

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - OBSERVE

The Heart of the Problem

Read the passage slowly, more than once. First notice what it actually says before deciding what it means.

ROMANS 7:15, 18-19

"I do not understand what I do. For what I want to do I do not do, but what I hate I do... For I have the desire to do what is good, but I cannot carry it out. For I do not do the good I want to do, but the evil I do not want to do - this I keep on doing."

Observation - What does it say?

1. What tension does Paul describe in himself?

2. Does he lack the desire to do good?

3. What does he keep doing anyway?

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - INTERPRET & APPLY

The Heart of the Problem

Interpretation - What does it mean?

1. Why is willpower alone not enough to fix sin?

2. How does Paul's honesty encourage you?

Application - What will I do?

1. Where do you experience Paul's struggle?

2. What does this reveal about your need for help beyond yourself?

WORD STUDY

Sin

MEANING

Falling short of God's standard; rebellion against God and the brokenness that flows from it.

Where It Appears**ISAIAH 64:6**

"All of us have become like one who is unclean."

1 JOHN 1:8

"If we claim to be without sin, we deceive ourselves."

Dig Deeper

1. Why do people resist the word 'sin' today?

2. How is honesty about sin actually freeing rather than shaming?

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

Facing the Truth

What sin patterns do you keep returning to?

Where have you tried to fix yourself and failed?

What would it mean to bring this honestly to God?

FAITH & WORLDVIEW

Aren't People Basically Good?

THE QUESTION

If humans are made in God's image, why say we're sinful?

Think It Through**Both are true**

People carry real dignity and real brokenness at the same time.

The evidence

History and honest self-reflection both reveal that good intentions aren't enough.

Not despair

Naming sin isn't hating humanity; it's diagnosing a problem so it can be healed.

Your Response

1. How do you hold together human dignity and human sinfulness?

2. Where have you seen good intentions fail to produce good?

UNIT 4

The Rescue

"For God so loved the world that he gave his one and only Son." - John 3:16

Unit Overview

This unit is the heart of the gospel: what Jesus did on the cross and at the resurrection, and how it answers the problem of sin.

DEVOTIONAL

The Great Exchange

The whole Bible builds to a rescue. This is the center of the Christian faith.

2 CORINTHIANS 5:21

"God made him who had no sin to be sin for us, so that in him we might become the righteousness of God."

On the cross, Jesus took what we deserved and gave us what we could never earn. That's the exchange at the heart of the gospel.

Grace is not God ignoring sin; it's God absorbing its cost himself.

Reflect

1. What does it mean to you that Jesus took your place?

2. Have you personally received this rescue, or just heard about it?

PRAYER PROMPT

Jesus, thank you for taking my place. Help me truly receive your grace.

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - OBSERVE

It Is Finished

Read the passage slowly, more than once. First notice what it actually says before deciding what it means.

JOHN 19:28-30

"Later, knowing that everything had now been finished, and so that Scripture would be fulfilled, Jesus said, 'I am thirsty.' A jar of wine vinegar was there, so they soaked a sponge in it, put the sponge on a stalk of the hyssop plant, and lifted it to Jesus' lips. When he had received the drink, Jesus said, 'It is finished.' With that, he bowed his head and gave up his spirit."

Observation - What does it say?

1. What does Jesus know at this moment?

2. What are his final words?

3. What is 'finished'?

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - INTERPRET & APPLY

It Is Finished

Interpretation - What does it mean?

1. Why does 'It is finished' matter for how we relate to God?

2. What can you not add to a finished work?

Application - What will I do?

1. Where are you still trying to 'finish' what Jesus already finished?

2. How does this bring rest?

WORD STUDY

Salvation

MEANING

God's rescue of people from sin and death, freely given through faith in Jesus Christ.

Where It Appears**EPHESIANS 2:8-9**

"For it is by grace you have been saved, through faith."

ROMANS 10:9

"If you declare with your mouth 'Jesus is Lord' and believe... you will be saved."

Dig Deeper

1. Why is it important that salvation is received, not earned?

2. What does declaring 'Jesus is Lord' actually commit you to?

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

My Response

Where are you in your response to Jesus' rescue?

What holds you back from fully trusting him?

Write a prayer responding to the cross.

SMALL GROUP DISCUSSION

Talk It Over

The cross is the center. Talk about what it means personally.

1. Why do you think grace is so hard to accept?

2. How would you explain the gospel to a friend in one minute?

3. How can this group pray for each other's next step?

UNIT 5

New Life

"Therefore, if anyone is in Christ, the new creation has come." - 2 Corinthians 5:17

Unit Overview

Salvation isn't just forgiveness of the past; it's a new identity and a new power to live. This unit explores what changes when you follow Jesus.

DEVOTIONAL

Made New

Following Jesus is not turning over a new leaf by willpower; it's receiving new life.

2 CORINTHIANS 5:17

"Therefore, if anyone is in Christ, the new creation has come: The old has gone, the new is here!"

You are not just forgiven and left the same; you are given the Holy Spirit and a new identity.

Growth is now cooperation with a power inside you, not a solo effort to be good enough.

Reflect

1. What 'old' things do you most want to leave behind?

2. How does having God's Spirit change the way you fight sin?

PRAYER PROMPT

God, thank you for new life. Help me live from who I now am in you.

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - OBSERVE

Life in the Spirit

Read the passage slowly, more than once. First notice what it actually says before deciding what it means.

GALATIANS 5:16-18

"So I say, walk by the Spirit, and you will not gratify the desires of the flesh. For the flesh desires what is contrary to the Spirit, and the Spirit what is contrary to the flesh. They are in conflict with each other, so that you are not to do whatever you want. But if you are led by the Spirit, you are not under the law."

Observation - What does it say?

1. What are we told to walk by?

2. What two things are in conflict?

3. What happens when we're led by the Spirit?

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - INTERPRET & APPLY

Life in the Spirit

Interpretation - What does it mean?

1. What does it mean to 'walk by the Spirit' daily?

2. Why is this a walk, not a single leap?

Application - What will I do?

1. Where is the 'flesh vs. Spirit' battle strongest in you?

2. What is one Spirit-led step this week?

WORD STUDY

Regeneration

MEANING

The new spiritual birth God gives believers - being 'born again' with new life and desires.

Where It Appears**JOHN 3:3**

"No one can see the kingdom of God unless they are born again."

TITUS 3:5

"He saved us through the washing of rebirth and renewal by the Holy Spirit."

Dig Deeper

1. What is the difference between self-improvement and being 'born again'?

2. What new desires have you noticed since drawing near to God?

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

The New Me

What has begun to change as you've grown in faith?

What old pattern do you want God to keep transforming?

What does 'new life' look like for you practically?

APPLICATION CHALLENGE

Live the New Life

New life is lived out in daily choices. Practice it.

This Week's Challenges

- ☐ Start each day acknowledging your identity in Christ.
- ☐ When tempted, pause and ask the Spirit for help.
- ☐ Replace one old habit with a life-giving one this week.
- ☐ Thank God each night for one way he helped you.

What happened when you tried?

UNIT 6

Living It Out

"Let your light shine before others." - Matthew 5:16

Unit Overview

Faith is meant to be lived in community and shared with the world. This unit looks at the church, mission, and a life that points to Jesus.

DEVOTIONAL

Not Meant to Be Alone

Christianity was never designed as a solo sport. You grow in community and shine outward.

MATTHEW 5:16

"Let your light shine before others, that they may see your good deeds and glorify your Father in heaven."

Your faith is personal but not private. It's meant to be visible and shared - not to show off, but to point to God.

You also need others: a community to grow with, be honest with, and be strengthened by.

Reflect

1. Do you have a community that helps your faith grow? If not, how could you find one?

2. How is your faith visible - or hidden - right now?

PRAYER PROMPT

God, plant me in real community and let my life point to you.

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - OBSERVE

The Early Church

Read the passage slowly, more than once. First notice what it actually says before deciding what it means.

ACTS 2:42-47

"They devoted themselves to the apostles' teaching and to fellowship, to the breaking of bread and to prayer... All the believers were together and had everything in common. They sold property and possessions to give to anyone who had need. Every day they continued to meet together... And the Lord added to their number daily those who were being saved."

Observation - What does it say?

1. List what the believers devoted themselves to.

2. How did they treat their possessions?

3. What happened as a result?

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - INTERPRET & APPLY

The Early Church

Interpretation - What does it mean?

1. Why is community central to this picture of faith?

2. What made this community attractive to outsiders?

Application - What will I do?

1. Which of these practices is missing from your life?

2. How could you help build community like this?

WORD STUDY

Church

MEANING

Not a building but the community of Jesus' followers - his family, called to worship, grow, and serve together.

Where It Appears**MATTHEW 18:20**

"For where two or three gather in my name, there am I with them."

HEBREWS 10:24

"Let us consider how we may spur one another on toward love and good deeds."

Dig Deeper

1. What has your experience of church been - good, bad, mixed?

2. What could you contribute to a community of believers?

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

My Next Steps

What is the most important thing you've learned in this study?

What is one way you'll live your faith more openly?

Write a prayer for the road ahead.

SMALL GROUP DISCUSSION

Commissioned

The final discussion. Look outward and forward.

1. How can your faith be more visible without being fake?

2. What's your plan for staying in Christian community?

3. How can this group keep encouraging each other after this study?

MEMORY & MEDITATION

Hide This Word in Your Heart

GENESIS 1:1

"Genesis 1:1"

Context

Look back over the verses you studied in this book.

Why It Matters

Scripture memorized becomes a resource the Holy Spirit can bring to mind in real moments of decision, temptation, doubt, and encouragement.

Write It From Memory

LIVE IT OUT THIS WEEK

Choose one verse from this book to carry with you all week.

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

Memory Verse Review

Write out from memory: Genesis 1:1

Write out from memory: Genesis 1:27

Write out from memory: Romans 3:23

Write out from memory: John 3:16

Write out from memory: 2 Corinthians 5:17

SELF-ASSESSMENT

Spiritual Check-In

Rate each statement honestly. This is between you and God - there are no wrong answers, only honest starting points.

1 = rarely 5 = consistently

I make time to read the Bible on my own.

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

I pray about real things in my life, not just at meals.

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

I can explain what I believe and why.

1	2	3	4	5
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I treat people the way Jesus would.

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I invite God into my decisions before I make them.

1	2	3	4	5
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I am honest even when it costs me.

1	2	3	4	5
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I serve others without expecting anything back.

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

I go to God first when I am anxious or afraid.

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

Final Reflection

Which foundation truth do you most need to stand on?

How has your understanding of God, yourself, and the gospel grown?

Write a prayer committing your foundation to Christ.

NOTES

Study Notes

NOTES

Study Notes



FAITH FOUNDATIONS STUDY SERIES

Christian Character & Integrity Study Workbook

Becoming Trustworthy, Honest, and Whole in a Watching World - For
Ages 13-19

Written by Daniel Tesfamariam



Ages 13-19 - Homeschool & Youth Groups

Personal Study - Small Groups - Reproducible for one household or class

HOW TO USE THIS STUDY

Getting the Most From This Workbook

Talent gets attention, but character determines whether you can be trusted with it. This six-unit study tackles the character issues teens actually face: integrity, honesty, purity, humility, and how to handle both failure and success. Honest, practical, and rooted in Scripture. For ages 13 to 19.

PROVERBS 4:23

"Above all else, guard your heart, for everything you do flows from it."

A Few Suggestions

- ☐ Find a consistent time and place. Even 15 focused minutes beats an hour you never start.
- ☐ Keep a pen in hand. Writing your answers turns reading into real thinking.
- ☐ Read each passage in your own Bible too, and note the version differences.
- ☐ Be honest in the reflection and journal sections - no one is grading you.
- ☐ If you meet with a group, come having already written your answers.
- ☐ Pray before you begin. Ask God to teach you, not just inform you.

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UNIT 1

Integrity: Whole in Public and Private

"The one whose walk is blameless... who keeps an oath even when it hurts." -
Psalm 15:2-4

Unit Overview

Integrity means being the same person when no one is watching. This unit examines honesty, consistency, and the cost of a divided life.

DEVOTIONAL

Who You Are in the Dark

Character is who you are when there are no cameras, no parents, and no consequences in sight.

PROVERBS 10:9

"Whoever walks in integrity walks securely, but whoever takes crooked paths will be found out."

Integrity is wholeness - your private self and public self are the same. A divided life is exhausting and fragile.

The internet has made it easy to be one person online and another in person. God calls us to one honest self.

Reflect

1. Where are you most tempted to live a divided life?

2. What would 'walking securely' feel like compared to hiding?

PRAYER PROMPT

God, make me one whole person - the same in the light and the dark.

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - OBSERVE

A Person of Integrity

Read the passage slowly, more than once. First notice what it actually says before deciding what it means.

DANIEL 6:3-4

"Now Daniel so distinguished himself among the administrators and the satraps by his exceptional qualities that the king planned to set him over the whole kingdom. At this, the administrators and the satraps tried to find grounds for charges against Daniel in his conduct of government affairs, but they were unable to do so. They could find no corruption in him, because he was trustworthy and neither corrupt nor negligent."

Observation - What does it say?

1. What set Daniel apart?

2. What were his rivals looking for?

3. What did they find?

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - INTERPRET & APPLY

A Person of Integrity

Interpretation - What does it mean?

1. Why couldn't his enemies find dirt on him?

2. What does 'neither corrupt nor negligent' require daily?

Application - What will I do?

1. Could people find 'no corruption' in your private life?

2. What area needs cleaning up?

WORD STUDY

Integrity

MEANING

Moral wholeness; being undivided and consistent in character, honest whether or not anyone sees.

Where It Appears

PSALM 25:21

"May integrity and uprightness protect me."

PROVERBS 11:3

"The integrity of the upright guides them."

Dig Deeper

1. How does integrity actually 'protect' a person?

2. Where is your integrity most tested - online, friendships, schoolwork?

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

My Private Self

Where does your private self differ from your public image?

What secret habit would you be embarrassed to have exposed?

What would it take to close that gap?

APPLICATION CHALLENGE

One Honest Week

Integrity is built by small, consistent choices. Try these.

This Week's Challenges

- ☐ Tell the full truth even when a half-truth is easier.
- ☐ Do your work honestly with no shortcuts or cheating.
- ☐ Match your online self to your real self for one week.
- ☐ Keep a promise that's become inconvenient.

What happened when you tried?

UNIT 2

Honesty and the Words We Use

"The Lord detests lying lips, but he delights in people who are trustworthy." -
Proverbs 12:22

Unit Overview

Words build or destroy. This unit studies honesty, gossip, and the power of the tongue for teens navigating group chats and reputations.

DEVOTIONAL

The Weight of Words

A single sentence can lift someone up for weeks or crush them for years. Words are never neutral.

PROVERBS 18:21

"The tongue has the power of life and death, and those who love it will eat its fruit."

In an age of group chats and comments, words travel faster and hit harder than ever.

Honesty isn't only about not lying; it's about using words to give life, not death.

Reflect

1. When have your words hurt someone? When have they helped?

2. How do your online words compare to your in-person words?

PRAYER PROMPT

God, tame my tongue. Let my words give life.

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - OBSERVE

Taming the Tongue

Read the passage slowly, more than once. First notice what it actually says before deciding what it means.

JAMES 3:5-6, 9-10

"Likewise, the tongue is a small part of the body, but it makes great boasts. Consider what a great forest is set on fire by a small spark. The tongue also is a fire... With the tongue we praise our Lord and Father, and with it we curse human beings, who have been made in God's likeness. Out of the same mouth come praise and cursing. My brothers and sisters, this should not be."

Observation - What does it say?

1. What small things do the spark and tongue have in common?

2. What contradiction does James point out?

3. What is his verdict?

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - INTERPRET & APPLY

Taming the Tongue

Interpretation - What does it mean?

1. Why is the tongue compared to a fire?

2. How can the same mouth both bless and curse?

Application - What will I do?

1. Where do your words most need taming?

2. What would 'praise not cursing' look like in your group chats?

WORD STUDY

Truthfulness

MEANING

Speaking and living in accordance with reality; being reliable in word and deed.

Where It Appears**COLOSSIANS 3:9**

"Do not lie to each other, since you have taken off your old self."

EPHESIANS 4:15

"Speaking the truth in love, we will grow to become... Christ."

Dig Deeper

1. What is the difference between blunt honesty and 'truth in love'?

2. When is silence more honest than speaking?

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

Words That Build

Whose words have shaped you most - for good or ill?

Where do you struggle with gossip or exaggeration?

Who could you build up with your words this week?

SMALL GROUP DISCUSSION

Talk It Over

Words are especially powerful in our connected world. Be honest.

1. How is honesty harder or easier online?

2. Where does gossip sneak into our friend groups?

3. How can this group speak life to each other?

UNIT 3

Purity and Self-Control

"God gave us a spirit not of fear but of power, love and self-control." - 2 Timothy 1:7

Unit Overview

This unit addresses desires, discipline, and purity of heart and body with honesty and grace, not shame.

DEVOTIONAL

Ruled or Ruling

You either master your desires or they master you. There's no neutral setting.

PROVERBS 25:28

"Like a city whose walls are broken through is a person who lacks self-control."

A city without walls is defenseless. A life without self-control is exposed to whatever pushes hardest.

Self-control isn't about hating your desires; it's about not being enslaved by them. And it's a gift the Spirit grows in you.

Reflect

1. Where do your desires currently 'rule' you?

2. What would freedom in that area look like?

PRAYER PROMPT

God, build strong walls in me. Free me to rule my desires rather than be ruled.

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - OBSERVE

Flee and Pursue

Read the passage slowly, more than once. First notice what it actually says before deciding what it means.

1 CORINTHIANS 6:18-20

"Flee from sexual immorality. All other sins a person commits are outside the body, but whoever sins sexually, sins against their own body. Do you not know that your bodies are temples of the Holy Spirit, who is in you, whom you have received from God? You are not your own; you were bought at a price. Therefore honor God with your bodies."

Observation - What does it say?

1. What are we told to do about sexual immorality?

2. What are our bodies called?

3. Why are we 'not our own'?

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - INTERPRET & APPLY

Flee and Pursue

Interpretation - What does it mean?

1. Why does Paul say to 'flee' rather than resist head-on?

2. How does 'bought at a price' shape how we treat our bodies?

Application - What will I do?

1. What do you need to 'flee' rather than flirt with?

2. How can you honor God with your body this week?

WORD STUDY

Purity

MEANING

Cleanness of heart and life; being undivided in devotion to God, including in thoughts, desires, and actions.

Where It Appears**MATTHEW 5:8**

"Blessed are the pure in heart, for they will see God."

PSALM 119:9

"How can a young person stay on the path of purity? By living according to your word."

Dig Deeper

1. Why does Jesus start purity in the heart, not just behavior?

2. How does God's word practically help with purity?

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

My Battle

What desire is hardest for you to control?

What triggers tend to trip you up?

What boundaries or help do you need to put in place?

APPLICATION CHALLENGE

Guard Your Heart

Self-control grows with practical guardrails. Choose real ones.

This Week's Challenges

- ☐ Identify one trigger and remove or limit it this week.
- ☐ Ask a trusted friend or mentor to check in with you.
- ☐ Memorize one verse for moments of temptation.
- ☐ Replace a tempting habit with a healthy alternative.

What happened when you tried?

UNIT 4

Humility and Handling Success

"Pride goes before destruction, a haughty spirit before a fall." - Proverbs 16:18

Unit Overview

Character is tested not only by failure but by success and attention. This unit explores humility, pride, and staying grounded.

DEVOTIONAL

Staying Grounded

It's easy to trust God when you're struggling. Success is the harder test of character.

1 PETER 5:6

"Humble yourselves, therefore, under God's mighty hand, that he may lift you up in due time."

Pride quietly takes credit and forgets God. Humility remembers where gifts come from.

Humility isn't thinking less of yourself; it's thinking of yourself less, and of God and others more.

Reflect

1. Where does pride sneak into your life - talents, looks, achievements?

2. How do you handle praise and attention?

PRAYER PROMPT

God, keep me humble in success and grounded in you.

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - OBSERVE

The Greatest Is the Servant

Read the passage slowly, more than once. First notice what it actually says before deciding what it means.

MARK 10:42-45

"Jesus called them together and said, 'You know that those who are regarded as rulers of the Gentiles lord it over them, and their high officials exercise authority over them. Not so with you. Instead, whoever wants to become great among you must be your servant, and whoever wants to be first must be slave of all. For even the Son of Man did not come to be served, but to serve, and to give his life as a ransom for many.'"

Observation - What does it say?

1. How do worldly rulers act?

2. What is Jesus' definition of greatness?

3. What example does Jesus give?

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - INTERPRET & APPLY

The Greatest Is the Servant

Interpretation - What does it mean?

1. Why does Jesus flip the definition of greatness?

2. How is serving harder than ruling?

Application - What will I do?

1. Where do you want to be 'great,' and how could you serve there instead?

2. Who could you serve this week?

WORD STUDY

Humility

MEANING

A right view of yourself before God and others; freedom from pride that serves rather than seeks status.

Where It Appears

JAMES 4:6

"God opposes the proud but shows favor to the humble."

PHILIPPIANS 2:3

"In humility value others above yourselves."

Dig Deeper

1. Why does God 'oppose the proud'?

2. How is humility different from insecurity or low self-worth?

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

Pride Check

Where are you tempted to take credit that belongs to God?

How do you respond to others' success?

What would humble confidence look like for you?

SMALL GROUP DISCUSSION

Talk It Over

Pride hides well. Help each other see it.

1. Where does pride show up in students our age?

2. How can we celebrate others without jealousy?

3. What does servant leadership look like at school?

UNIT 5

Perseverance and Handling Failure

"Consider it pure joy... whenever you face trials of many kinds." - James 1:2

Unit Overview

Everyone fails. Character is shaped by how you respond. This unit is about resilience, repentance, and getting back up.

DEVOTIONAL

Getting Back Up

Failure isn't final unless you let it define you. Even David, Peter, and Paul failed badly and were restored.

PROVERBS 24:16

"For though the righteous fall seven times, they rise again."

The mark of the righteous isn't that they never fall; it's that they get back up, by grace.

God is not surprised by your failure and is not done with you because of it.

Reflect

1. What failure have you let define you?

2. What would 'rising again' look like from here?

PRAYER PROMPT

God, thank you that failure isn't final. Help me get back up.

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - OBSERVE

Restored After Failure

Read the passage slowly, more than once. First notice what it actually says before deciding what it means.

JOHN 21:15-17

"When they had finished eating, Jesus said to Simon Peter, 'Simon son of John, do you love me more than these?' 'Yes, Lord,' he said, 'you know that I love you.' Jesus said, 'Feed my lambs.' Again Jesus said, 'Simon son of John, do you love me?' ... The third time he said to him, 'Simon son of John, do you love me?' Peter was hurt... He said, 'Lord, you know all things; you know that I love you.' Jesus said, 'Feed my sheep.'"

Observation - What does it say?

1. What had Peter done days earlier?

2. How many times does Jesus ask?

3. What does Jesus call Peter back to?

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - INTERPRET & APPLY

Restored After Failure

Interpretation - What does it mean?

1. Why might Jesus ask three times?

2. What does this reveal about how God handles our failure?

Application - What will I do?

1. What failure do you need to hear Jesus restore?

2. What is he calling you back to?

WORD STUDY

Perseverance

MEANING

Steadfast endurance; continuing to trust and obey God through trials and setbacks.

Where It Appears**JAMES 1:12**

"Blessed is the one who perseveres under trial."

HEBREWS 12:1

"Let us run with perseverance the race marked out for us."

Dig Deeper

1. What is the difference between perseverance and stubbornness?

2. What trial is God using to build endurance in you?

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

My Comeback

Write about a failure that still weighs on you.

What have you learned through it?

What would it look like to move forward with God?

APPLICATION CHALLENGE

Rise Again

Resilience is a practice, not a personality type. Try these.

This Week's Challenges

- ☐ Confess one failure to God and receive his forgiveness.
- ☐ Take one step to make right what you can.
- ☐ Reframe a failure as a lesson in writing.
- ☐ Encourage someone else who has stumbled.

What happened when you tried?

UNIT 6

A Character That Points to Christ

"In the same way, let your light shine before others." - Matthew 5:16

Unit Overview

This unit ties character to witness: the goal isn't just being a 'good person' but reflecting Jesus so others see him in you.

DEVOTIONAL

The Point of Character

Christian character isn't about earning a good reputation. It's about pointing to the One who changed you.

MATTHEW 5:16

"Let your light shine before others, that they may see your good deeds and glorify your Father in heaven."

Notice the goal: not that people praise you, but that they glorify God. Character is a signpost, not a spotlight.

The most powerful argument for Christ is often a life quietly transformed by him.

Reflect

1. Does your character point people to God or to yourself?

2. Where has God clearly changed you in a way others could notice?

PRAYER PROMPT

God, let my character point to you, not to me.

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - OBSERVE

Living Among Watchers

Read the passage slowly, more than once. First notice what it actually says before deciding what it means.

1 PETER 2:11-12

"Dear friends, I urge you, as foreigners and exiles, to abstain from sinful desires, which wage war against your soul. Live such good lives among the pagans that, though they accuse you of doing wrong, they may see your good deeds and glorify God on the day he visits us."

Observation - What does it say?

1. What are believers urged to abstain from?

2. How are we to live 'among' others?

3. What might result?

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - INTERPRET & APPLY

Living Among Watchers

Interpretation - What does it mean?

1. Why does Peter call us 'foreigners and exiles'?

2. How can good lives answer accusations?

Application - What will I do?

1. Who is watching your life right now?

2. What 'good deeds' could point them to God?

WORD STUDY

Witness

MEANING

A person whose life and words testify to the truth about Jesus.

Where It Appears

ACTS 1:8

"You will be my witnesses."

1 PETER 3:15

"Always be prepared to give an answer... for the hope that you have."

Dig Deeper

1. How does your life 'testify' before you ever say a word?

2. What 'hope' would you point to if someone asked?

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

The Legacy I'm Building

What kind of character do you want to be known for?

What has this study revealed you need to grow in?

Write a prayer about the person God is shaping you to be.

SMALL GROUP DISCUSSION

Commissioned

Final discussion. Character is a lifelong project.

1. Which area of character will you keep working on?

2. How can your character point others to Jesus?

3. How can this group keep each other accountable?

MEMORY & MEDITATION

Hide This Word in Your Heart

PSALM 15:2-4

"Psalm 15:2-4"

Context

Look back over the verses you studied in this book.

Why It Matters

Scripture memorized becomes a resource the Holy Spirit can bring to mind in real moments of decision, temptation, doubt, and encouragement.

Write It From Memory

LIVE IT OUT THIS WEEK

Choose one verse from this book to carry with you all week.

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

Memory Verse Review

Write out from memory: Psalm 15:2-4

Write out from memory: Proverbs 12:22

Write out from memory: 2 Timothy 1:7

Write out from memory: Proverbs 16:18

Write out from memory: James 1:2

SELF-ASSESSMENT

Spiritual Check-In

Rate each statement honestly. This is between you and God - there are no wrong answers, only honest starting points.

1 = rarely 5 = consistently

I make time to read the Bible on my own.

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I pray about real things in my life, not just at meals.

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I can explain what I believe and why.

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I treat people the way Jesus would.

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I invite God into my decisions before I make them.

1	2	3	4	5
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I am honest even when it costs me.

1	2	3	4	5
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I serve others without expecting anything back.

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

I go to God first when I am anxious or afraid.

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

Final Reflection

Which area of character grew most through this study?

Where do you still need God's help?

Write a prayer committing your character to Christ.

NOTES

Study Notes

NOTES

Study Notes



FAITH FOUNDATIONS STUDY SERIES

Bible Heroes & Their Faith: A Study Workbook

The Real Stories, Failures, and Faith of Scripture's Great Figures - For Ages 13-19

Written by Daniel Tesfamariam



Ages 13-19 - Homeschool & Youth Groups

Personal Study - Small Groups - Reproducible for one household or class

HOW TO USE THIS STUDY

Getting the Most From This Workbook

The Bible's heroes weren't superhuman - they were flawed people who trusted (and sometimes failed) an extraordinary God. This six-unit study digs into Abraham, Moses, Esther, David, Daniel, and ultimately Jesus, asking what their faith demands of yours. For ages 13 to 19.

HEBREWS 12:1

"Therefore, since we are surrounded by such a great cloud of witnesses..."

A Few Suggestions

- ☐ Find a consistent time and place. Even 15 focused minutes beats an hour you never start.
- ☐ Keep a pen in hand. Writing your answers turns reading into real thinking.
- ☐ Read each passage in your own Bible too, and note the version differences.
- ☐ Be honest in the reflection and journal sections - no one is grading you.
- ☐ If you meet with a group, come having already written your answers.
- ☐ Pray before you begin. Ask God to teach you, not just inform you.

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UNIT 1

Abraham: The Faith to Go

"By faith Abraham... obeyed and went, even though he did not know where he was going." - Hebrews 11:8

Unit Overview

Abraham left everything on God's promise. His life models faith that obeys before it understands, and trusts God with the unknown.

DEVOTIONAL

Leaving the Familiar

God's first command to Abraham was to leave - home, security, plans - for a destination not yet revealed.

GENESIS 12:1

"The Lord had said to Abram, 'Go from your country, your people and your father's household to the land I will show you.'"

Abraham had to trust the Promiser before he could see the promise. Faith often moves before it sees.

God rarely shows the whole path at once; he asks for the next step of trust.

Reflect

1. What 'familiar' thing might God be asking you to hold loosely?

2. Where do you want the whole map before you'll take a step?

PRAYER PROMPT

God, give me faith to obey the next step even when I can't see the whole path.

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - OBSERVE

Counted as Righteous

Read the passage slowly, more than once. First notice what it actually says before deciding what it means.

GENESIS 15:5-6

"He took him outside and said, 'Look up at the sky and count the stars - if indeed you can count them.' Then he said to him, 'So shall your offspring be.' Abram believed the Lord, and he credited it to him as righteousness."

Observation - What does it say?

1. What does God ask Abram to look at?

2. What does God promise?

3. What was 'credited' to Abram, and why?

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - INTERPRET & APPLY

Counted as Righteous

Interpretation - What does it mean?

1. Why is Abram's belief - not his works - counted as righteousness?

2. How does this preview the whole gospel?

Application - What will I do?

1. Where do you need to simply believe God's promise?

2. How does faith, not performance, change how you relate to God?

WORD STUDY

Righteousness

MEANING

Being right with God. In the gospel, it is credited to us through faith, not earned by works.

Where It Appears**ROMANS 4:3**

"Abraham believed God, and it was credited to him as righteousness."

2 CORINTHIANS 5:21

"God made him... to be sin for us, so that in him we might become the righteousness of God."

Dig Deeper

1. Why is credited righteousness such good news?

2. How does this free you from trying to earn God's approval?

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

My Step of Faith

Where is God asking you to trust him with an unknown?

What fears hold you back?

What would obedience look like this week?

FAITH & WORLDVIEW

Isn't Faith Just Wishful Thinking?

THE QUESTION

How is trusting God different from hoping something works out?

Think It Through**Based on a track record**

Abraham trusted God because of who God had shown himself to be, not blind optimism.

Costly, not convenient

Real faith often demands sacrifice - the opposite of comfortable wishing.

Relational trust

Faith is trusting a Person, like trusting a proven friend, not gambling on luck.

Your Response

1. How would you explain the difference between faith and wishful thinking?

2. What has built - or shaken - your trust in God?

UNIT 2

Moses: From Excuses to Obedience

"Who am I that I should go to Pharaoh?" - Exodus 3:11

Unit Overview

Moses felt unqualified and made excuses, yet God used him powerfully. His story speaks to insecurity, calling, and God's sufficiency.

DEVOTIONAL

Feeling Unqualified

Moses' response to God's call was a list of reasons he was the wrong guy. God wasn't deterred.

EXODUS 4:10

"Moses said to the Lord, 'Pardon your servant, Lord. I have never been eloquent... I am slow of speech and tongue.'"

God's answer wasn't 'You're amazing, actually.' It was 'I will be with you.' The qualification is God's presence, not our resume.

Feeling inadequate isn't disqualifying; refusing to trust the God who calls you is.

Reflect

1. Where do you feel unqualified for something God might be asking?

2. How does 'I will be with you' change the equation?

PRAYER PROMPT

God, when I feel inadequate, remind me that you go with me.

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - OBSERVE

The Call and the Excuse

Read the passage slowly, more than once. First notice what it actually says before deciding what it means.

EXODUS 3:10-12

"So now, go. I am sending you to Pharaoh to bring my people the Israelites out of Egypt.' But Moses said to God, 'Who am I that I should go to Pharaoh and bring the Israelites out of Egypt?' And God said, 'I will be with you. And this will be the sign to you that it is I who have sent you: When you have brought the people out of Egypt, you will worship God on this mountain.'"

Observation - What does it say?

1. What is God's command?

2. What is Moses' objection?

3. What is God's core reassurance?

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - INTERPRET & APPLY

The Call and the Excuse

Interpretation - What does it mean?

1. Why does God answer 'Who am I?' with 'I will be with you' instead of praising Moses?

2. What does that teach about calling?

Application - What will I do?

1. What excuse are you hiding behind?

2. How would you act if you truly believed God was with you?

WORD STUDY

Calling

MEANING

God's summons to a person for his purposes - often to something beyond their comfort or ability.

Where It Appears**1 THESSALONIANS 5:24**

"The one who calls you is faithful, and he will do it."

ROMANS 11:29

"God's gifts and his call are irrevocable."

Dig Deeper

1. What might God be calling you toward, even in small ways, right now?

2. How is God's faithfulness the key to answering a calling?

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

My Excuses

What excuses do you make when God nudges you?

What insecurity is underneath them?

What would trusting God's presence change?

SMALL GROUP DISCUSSION

Talk It Over

Everyone feels unqualified sometimes. Be honest together.

1. Where do people our age feel 'not enough'?

2. How does comparison feed our excuses?

3. How can this group encourage each other's callings?

UNIT 3

Esther: The Right Person at the Right Time

"For such a time as this." - Esther 4:14

Unit Overview

Esther used her position and took a great risk for others. Her story is about influence, timing, and courage to act.

DEVOTIONAL

Your Position on Purpose

You didn't land in your school, family, or friend group by accident. God positions people.

ESTHER 4:14

"And who knows but that you have come to your royal position for such a time as this?"

Esther's crown wasn't just a privilege; it was a platform for others' good.

Wherever you have influence - however small - is a place God can use you for someone else's rescue.

Reflect

1. Where do you have influence you tend to overlook?

2. Who might need you to use it for their good?

PRAYER PROMPT

God, help me use where you've placed me for others, not just myself.

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - OBSERVE

Deciding to Act

Read the passage slowly, more than once. First notice what it actually says before deciding what it means.

ESTHER 4:13-16

"Mordecai sent back this answer: 'Do not think that because you are in the king's house you alone of all the Jews will escape... And who knows but that you have come to your royal position for such a time as this?' Then Esther sent this reply: 'Go, gather together all the Jews... and fast for me... When this is done, I will go to the king, even though it is against the law. And if I perish, I perish.'"

Observation - What does it say?

1. What warning does Mordecai give Esther?

2. What does Esther ask for first?

3. What is her final decision?

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - INTERPRET & APPLY

Deciding to Act

Interpretation - What does it mean?

1. Why does Esther seek prayer/fasting before acting?

2. What does her resolve cost her?

Application - What will I do?

1. What right thing have you been avoiding out of fear?

2. What would preparing and then acting look like?

WORD STUDY

Providence

MEANING

God's unseen guidance of events toward his good purposes - evident in Esther though God is never named.

Where It Appears**PROVERBS 19:21**

"Many are the plans in a person's heart, but it is the Lord's purpose that prevails."

PROVERBS 16:9

"In their hearts humans plan their course, but the Lord establishes their steps."

Dig Deeper

1. How does providence encourage you when life feels random?

2. Where might God be working behind the scenes in your life?

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

My Moment

What influence has God given you?

Is there a courageous, right action you're avoiding?

What would 'if I perish, I perish' resolve look like for you?

APPLICATION CHALLENGE

Use Your Position

Influence unused is influence wasted. Try these.

This Week's Challenges

- ☐ Stand up for someone who can't stand up for themselves.
- ☐ Use a talent or platform to serve, not just to shine.
- ☐ Do one brave, right thing you've been putting off.
- ☐ Pray before you act, like Esther did.

What happened when you tried?

UNIT 4

David: A Heart After God

"The Lord looks at the heart." - 1 Samuel 16:7

Unit Overview

David was a hero and a failure - brave, worshipful, and deeply flawed. His life teaches worship, repentance, and what God values.

DEVOTIONAL

What God Sees

When God chose David, everyone was looking at his older, taller brothers. God was looking somewhere else.

1 SAMUEL 16:7

"The Lord does not look at the things people look at. People look at the outward appearance, but the Lord looks at the heart."

In a world obsessed with image, God evaluates the heart - motives, devotion, character.

David wasn't chosen for his looks or resume, but for a heart oriented toward God (even when he failed).

Reflect

1. What 'outward appearance' do you worry about most?

2. What is the current condition of your heart toward God?

PRAYER PROMPT

God, you see my heart. Make it more devoted to you than to my image.

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - OBSERVE

A Broken and Contrite Heart

Read the passage slowly, more than once. First notice what it actually says before deciding what it means.

PSALM 51:1-4, 10

"Have mercy on me, O God, according to your unfailing love; according to your great compassion blot out my transgressions... Against you, you only, have I sinned and done what is evil in your sight... Create in me a pure heart, O God, and renew a steadfast spirit within me."

Observation - What does it say?

1. What does David ask God to do with his sin?

2. Who does David say he sinned against?

3. What does he ask God to create?

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - INTERPRET & APPLY

A Broken and Contrite Heart

Interpretation - What does it mean?

1. What does true repentance look like here?

2. Why does David focus on his heart, not just his behavior?

Application - What will I do?

1. Where do you need to pray Psalm 51 honestly?

2. What does 'create in me a pure heart' mean for you?

WORD STUDY

Repentance

MEANING

A turning - changing your mind and direction, away from sin and back toward God.

Where It Appears**ACTS 3:19**

"Repent, then, and turn to God, so that your sins may be wiped out."

2 CORINTHIANS 7:10

"Godly sorrow brings repentance that leads to salvation."

Dig Deeper

1. What is the difference between guilt and true repentance?

2. How is repentance good news rather than mere punishment?

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

The Condition of My Heart

What does God see in your heart that others don't?

Where do you need to repent and turn back?

Write your own short 'Psalm 51' prayer.

SMALL GROUP DISCUSSION

Talk It Over

David was both hero and failure. That's oddly encouraging.

1. Why does the Bible show its heroes' failures?

2. How does David's story give hope after failure?

3. What does a 'heart after God' look like day to day?

UNIT 5

Daniel: Faithful in a Foreign Culture

"Daniel resolved not to defile himself." - Daniel 1:8

Unit Overview

Daniel thrived in a pagan empire without compromising his faith. His life models conviction, wisdom, and prayer under pressure.

DEVOTIONAL

Deciding in Advance

Daniel didn't wait until pressure hit to decide who he'd be. He resolved beforehand.

DANIEL 1:8

"But Daniel resolved not to defile himself with the royal food and wine."

Convictions decided in the moment usually lose to pressure. Daniel decided in advance and held firm with grace.

You can honor God inside a culture that doesn't share your faith - with wisdom, not just defiance.

Reflect

1. What convictions do you need to settle before you're tested?

2. Where does your culture pressure you to 'defile' your convictions?

PRAYER PROMPT

God, help me decide in advance to honor you, and to do it wisely.

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - OBSERVE

Prayer Under Threat

Read the passage slowly, more than once. First notice what it actually says before deciding what it means.

DANIEL 6:10

"Now when Daniel learned that the decree had been published, he went home to his upstairs room where the windows opened toward Jerusalem. Three times a day he got down on his knees and prayed, giving thanks to his God, just as he had done before."

Observation - What does it say?

1. What had just been made illegal?

2. What did Daniel do anyway?

3. What phrase shows this wasn't new for him?

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - INTERPRET & APPLY

Prayer Under Threat

Interpretation - What does it mean?

1. Why is 'just as he had done before' significant?

2. How did habit prepare Daniel for crisis?

Application - What will I do?

1. What spiritual habits are you building now for future pressure?

2. Would your routine survive if it became costly?

WORD STUDY

Faithfulness

MEANING

Steady loyalty and reliability - being consistent with God over the long haul.

Where It Appears**MATTHEW 25:21**

"Well done, good and faithful servant!"

1 CORINTHIANS 4:2

"It is required that those who have been given a trust must prove faithful."

Dig Deeper

1. What does faithfulness look like when no one notices?

2. Where do you need more consistency with God?

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

Faith in My Culture

Where does your environment pressure your faith?

What convictions do you want to settle now?

What daily habit would strengthen you?

APPLICATION CHALLENGE

Build a Rhythm

Daniel's crisis courage came from daily faithfulness. Start now.

This Week's Challenges

- ☐ Pray at a set time each day this week.
- ☐ Decide one conviction in advance and write it down.
- ☐ Honor God at school or work in one visible, gracious way.
- ☐ Give thanks daily, like Daniel did, even under stress.

What happened when you tried?

UNIT 6

The Ultimate Hero: Jesus

"Fixing our eyes on Jesus, the pioneer and perfecter of faith." - Hebrews 12:2

Unit Overview

Every hero pointed forward to Jesus, who alone lived perfectly and rescued us. This unit centers faith on him, not just admirable examples.

DEVOTIONAL

More Than an Example

The Bible's heroes inspire us, but they all needed rescue too. Only Jesus is both the example and the Savior.

HEBREWS 12:2

"Let us fix our eyes on Jesus, the pioneer and perfecter of faith."

Abraham, Moses, David, and Daniel all failed. Jesus alone never did - and he died and rose to save the very heroes we admire.

Don't just try to imitate the heroes; trust the One they were all pointing to.

Reflect

1. Have you treated Jesus mainly as an example to copy or a Savior to trust?

2. How does fixing your eyes on Jesus change your faith?

PRAYER PROMPT

Jesus, you are more than a hero to admire. Be my Savior and Lord.

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - OBSERVE

The Faith of Jesus

Read the passage slowly, more than once. First notice what it actually says before deciding what it means.

PHILIPPIANS 2:5-8

"In your relationships with one another, have the same mindset as Christ Jesus: Who, being in very nature God, did not consider equality with God something to be used to his own advantage; rather, he made himself nothing by taking the very nature of a servant... And being found in appearance as a man, he humbled himself by becoming obedient to death - even death on a cross!"

Observation - What does it say?

1. What did Jesus not cling to?

2. What did he take on instead?

3. How far did his obedience go?

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - INTERPRET & APPLY

The Faith of Jesus

Interpretation - What does it mean?

1. How is Jesus the ultimate model of humility and obedience?

2. Why does it matter that God himself served and died?

Application - What will I do?

1. Where do you cling to advantage instead of serving?

2. How can you have 'the same mindset' this week?

WORD STUDY

Savior

MEANING

One who rescues. Jesus is the Savior who does for us what no hero could do for themselves - defeat sin and death.

Where It Appears**LUKE 2:11**

"Today in the town of David a Savior has been born to you; he is the Messiah, the Lord."

ACTS 4:12

"Salvation is found in no one else."

Dig Deeper

1. Why do we need a Savior and not just good role models?

2. What does it mean to trust Jesus as your Savior personally?

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

Fixing My Eyes

Which Bible hero encouraged you most, and why?

How is Jesus greater than all of them?

Write a prayer fixing your eyes on Jesus.

SMALL GROUP DISCUSSION

Commissioned

Final discussion. All the heroes point to Christ.

1. Which hero's faith challenged you most?

2. How will you keep 'fixing your eyes on Jesus' after this book?

3. How can this group encourage each other's faith journey?

MEMORY & MEDITATION

Hide This Word in Your Heart

HEBREWS 11:8

"Hebrews 11:8"

Context

Look back over the verses you studied in this book.

Why It Matters

Scripture memorized becomes a resource the Holy Spirit can bring to mind in real moments of decision, temptation, doubt, and encouragement.

Write It From Memory

LIVE IT OUT THIS WEEK

Choose one verse from this book to carry with you all week.

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

Memory Verse Review

Write out from memory: Hebrews 11:8

Write out from memory: Exodus 3:11

Write out from memory: Esther 4:14

Write out from memory: 1 Samuel 16:7

Write out from memory: Daniel 1:8

SELF-ASSESSMENT

Spiritual Check-In

Rate each statement honestly. This is between you and God - there are no wrong answers, only honest starting points.

1 = rarely 5 = consistently

I make time to read the Bible on my own.

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

I pray about real things in my life, not just at meals.

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

I can explain what I believe and why.

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

I treat people the way Jesus would.

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

I invite God into my decisions before I make them.

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

I am honest even when it costs me.

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

I serve others without expecting anything back.

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

I go to God first when I am anxious or afraid.

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

Final Reflection

Which hero's faith most challenged you?

How has this study changed how you see faith?

Write a prayer to have a heart like the heroes who followed God.

NOTES

Study Notes

NOTES

Study Notes



FAITH FOUNDATIONS STUDY SERIES

God's Creation, Science & Faith Study Workbook

Exploring Origins, Wonder, and Big Questions Without Fear - For Ages 13-19

Written by Daniel Tesfamariam



Ages 13-19 - Homeschool & Youth Groups

Personal Study - Small Groups - Reproducible for one household or class



HOW TO USE THIS STUDY

Getting the Most From This Workbook

Teens are often told they must pick faith or science. This six-unit study refuses that false choice. Explore what the Bible says about creation, the Fall, restoration, and worship - and work through honest questions about origins, suffering, and science with confidence, not fear. For ages 13 to 19.

PSALM 19:1

"The heavens declare the glory of God."

A Few Suggestions

- ☐ Find a consistent time and place. Even 15 focused minutes beats an hour you never start.
- ☐ Keep a pen in hand. Writing your answers turns reading into real thinking.
- ☐ Read each passage in your own Bible too, and note the version differences.
- ☐ Be honest in the reflection and journal sections - no one is grading you.
- ☐ If you meet with a group, come having already written your answers.
- ☐ Pray before you begin. Ask God to teach you, not just inform you.

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UNIT 1

The God Who Creates

"In the beginning God created the heavens and the earth." - Genesis 1:1

Unit Overview

This unit explores the Bible's claim that a personal God created all things with purpose - and why that changes how we see the universe and ourselves.

DEVOTIONAL

A Universe With an Author

The first four words of the Bible make a staggering claim: reality has an Author, not just an origin.

GENESIS 1:1

"In the beginning God created the heavens and the earth."

If the universe is authored, it has meaning and direction. If it's an accident, meaning is something we invent.

Genesis doesn't read like a science lab report; it reads like a declaration that everything belongs to God.

Reflect

1. Does it matter to you whether the universe has an Author? Why?

2. How would believing creation is purposeful change how you see your life?

PRAYER PROMPT

Creator God, help me see your world as authored and meaningful, not accidental.

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - OBSERVE

Creation Speaks

Read the passage slowly, more than once. First notice what it actually says before deciding what it means.

PSALM 19:1-4

"The heavens declare the glory of God; the skies proclaim the work of his hands. Day after day they pour forth speech; night after night they reveal knowledge. They have no speech, they use no words; no sound is heard from them. Yet their voice goes out into all the earth, their words to the ends of the world."

Observation - What does it say?

1. What do the heavens 'declare'?

2. How do they 'speak' without words?

3. How far does their message reach?

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - INTERPRET & APPLY

Creation Speaks

Interpretation - What does it mean?

1. How can creation communicate something true about God?

2. What can nature tell us - and not tell us - about God?

Application - What will I do?

1. When has nature made you sense something bigger than yourself?

2. How could you 'listen' to creation this week?

WORD STUDY

Creator

MEANING

The one who brings all things into being. God is distinct from creation, not part of it.

Where It Appears**COLOSSIANS 1:16**

"For in him all things were created: things in heaven and on earth."

REVELATION 4:11

"You are worthy... for you created all things."

Dig Deeper

1. Why does it matter that God is separate from creation, not the universe itself?

2. How does being a creature (not the Creator) give you both humility and worth?

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

Wonder

What part of the natural world amazes you most?

How does it point you toward or away from God?

Write a short prayer of wonder to the Creator.

FAITH & WORLDVIEW

Doesn't the Big Bang Replace God?

THE QUESTION

If science explains how the universe began, is God unnecessary?

Think It Through**How vs. Why**

Science can describe mechanisms; it can't explain why there's something rather than nothing.

A beginning invites a cause

A universe with a beginning raises the question of what caused it.

Not competitors

Describing how God may have done something doesn't remove God any more than knowing how an engine works removes the engineer.

Your Response

1. Have you felt science and faith must conflict? Where did that idea come from?

2. What question about origins do you most want to explore?

UNIT 2

Made in His Image

"So God created mankind in his own image." - Genesis 1:27

Unit Overview

Of all creation, humans are unique - image-bearers with dignity, purpose, and responsibility. This unit explores what that means for identity and ethics.

DEVOTIONAL

The Crown of Creation

In a vast universe, the Bible makes a bold claim: human beings uniquely bear God's image.

GENESIS 1:27

"So God created mankind in his own image, in the image of God he created them; male and female he created them."

Being an image-bearer means every person has dignity that no accomplishment adds and no failure removes.

It also means we're responsible - image-bearers are meant to reflect God's care into the world.

Reflect

1. How does being an image-bearer affect your sense of worth?

2. How should it change how you treat people you dislike or disagree with?

PRAYER PROMPT

God, help me see your image in myself and in every person.

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - OBSERVE

Given a Job

Read the passage slowly, more than once. First notice what it actually says before deciding what it means.

GENESIS 2:15

"The Lord God took the man and put him in the Garden of Eden to work it and take care of it."

Observation - What does it say?

1. What did God give the man to do?

2. Was work part of the world before or after sin?

3. What two verbs describe his task?

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - INTERPRET & APPLY

Given a Job

Interpretation - What does it mean?

1. What does it mean that work existed before the Fall?

2. How does 'take care of it' shape how we treat creation?

Application - What will I do?

1. How do you view work - as a curse or a calling?

2. How could you 'take care of' your corner of the world?

WORD STUDY

Stewardship

MEANING

Responsible care of what belongs to another. Humans are stewards, not owners, of creation.

Where It Appears**PSALM 24:1**

"The earth is the Lord's, and everything in it."

1 CORINTHIANS 4:2

"It is required that those who have been given a trust must prove faithful."

Dig Deeper

1. If the earth is 'the Lord's,' how should that shape how we live?

2. What has God entrusted to you to steward well?

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

My Dignity and Duty

Where do you struggle to believe you have worth?

Where do you fail to see others' worth?

What responsibility might God be giving you to steward?

SMALL GROUP DISCUSSION

Talk It Over

The image of God has huge implications. Discuss them.

1. How does 'image of God' challenge how our culture ranks people?

2. How should Christians think about caring for the environment?

3. How can this group treat each other as image-bearers?

UNIT 3

When Creation Broke

"Cursed is the ground because of you." - Genesis 3:17

Unit Overview

The world is beautiful but broken. This unit faces the Fall - how sin fractured creation - and why that explains the world we actually experience.

DEVOTIONAL

Beauty and Brokenness

Creation is stunning and also groaning. Both are true, and the Bible explains why.

ROMANS 8:20-21

"The creation was subjected to frustration... in hope that the creation itself will be liberated from its bondage to decay."

The same world that shows sunsets also shows disease and disaster. The Bible traces this tension to the Fall.

But notice the word 'hope': the brokenness is real but temporary. Creation is waiting to be set free.

Reflect

1. Where do you most feel the world's brokenness?

2. How does 'hope' of restoration help you hold that honestly?

PRAYER PROMPT

God, help me grieve what's broken while trusting your promise to restore it.

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - OBSERVE

Creation Groans

Read the passage slowly, more than once. First notice what it actually says before deciding what it means.

ROMANS 8:22-25

"We know that the whole creation has been groaning as in the pains of childbirth right up to the present time. Not only so, but we ourselves... groan inwardly as we wait eagerly for our adoption to sonship, the redemption of our bodies. For in this hope we were saved."

Observation - What does it say?

1. What is creation compared to?

2. Who else groans?

3. What are we waiting for?

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - INTERPRET & APPLY

Creation Groans

Interpretation - What does it mean?

1. Why 'pains of childbirth' rather than just decay?

2. How does hope change the way we experience suffering?

Application - What will I do?

1. What are you 'groaning' about right now?

2. How does future hope reshape present pain?

WORD STUDY

The Fall

MEANING

The event and ongoing reality of humanity's rebellion against God, which fractured creation and relationships.

Where It Appears

ROMANS 5:12

"Sin entered the world through one man, and death through sin."

1 JOHN 5:19

"The whole world is under the control of the evil one."

Dig Deeper

1. How does the Fall explain the mix of good and evil you see?

2. Why is it more honest than saying the world is either all good or all bad?

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

Honest About Brokenness

Where do you see brokenness in the world?

Where do you see it in yourself?

What hope do you need to hold onto?

FAITH & WORLDVIEW

Why Natural Disasters and Disease?

THE QUESTION

If God made a good world, why is nature sometimes deadly?

Think It Through**A world affected by the Fall**

The Bible describes creation itself as subject to frustration and decay.

Not the final state

Scripture promises a restored creation without death or pain.

God enters the suffering

The Christian hope isn't a God distant from pain but one who redeems it.

Your Response

1. How do you personally wrestle with natural suffering?

2. What would you say to a friend angry at God over a disaster?

UNIT 4

The Promise of Restoration

"Behold, I am making all things new." - Revelation 21:5

Unit Overview

The story doesn't end in brokenness. This unit explores the biblical hope of a renewed creation and how it shapes how we live now.

DEVOTIONAL

All Things New

The Bible doesn't end with escape to a distant heaven; it ends with heaven and earth renewed.

REVELATION 21:4

"He will wipe every tear from their eyes. There will be no more death or mourning or crying or pain, for the old order of things has passed away."

God's plan isn't to trash creation but to restore it. The future is physical, good, and whole.

This hope isn't escapism; it fuels people to work for good now as a preview of what's coming.

Reflect

1. How does the hope of restoration change how you view death and loss?

2. How might it motivate you to do good now?

PRAYER PROMPT

God, thank you that you are making all things new. Give me that hope.

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - OBSERVE

A New Creation

Read the passage slowly, more than once. First notice what it actually says before deciding what it means.

REVELATION 21:1-4

"Then I saw 'a new heaven and a new earth,' for the first heaven and the first earth had passed away... I heard a loud voice from the throne saying, 'Look! God's dwelling place is now among the people, and he will dwell with them...' He will wipe every tear from their eyes. There will be no more death or mourning or crying or pain."

Observation - What does it say?

1. What does John see?

2. Where is God's dwelling place now?

3. What will be no more?

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - INTERPRET & APPLY

A New Creation

Interpretation - What does it mean?

1. Why does it matter that God dwells with people, not far away?

2. How is this different from popular ideas of the afterlife?

Application - What will I do?

1. What tears do you long to have wiped away?

2. How does this future shape today?

WORD STUDY

Restoration

MEANING

God's renewal of all creation, healing what sin broke and making everything new.

Where It Appears**ROMANS 8:21**

"The creation itself will be liberated from its bondage to decay."

ACTS 3:21

"He must remain in heaven until the time comes for God to restore everything."

Dig Deeper

1. How is restoration different from destruction or escape?

2. What in your life do you most long to see restored?

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

Living in Hope

What future promise gives you the most hope?

How can that hope change how you live now?

Write a prayer of hope for restoration.

SMALL GROUP DISCUSSION

Talk It Over

The end of the story reshapes the middle. Discuss.

1. How does hope for the future affect how we treat the present world?

2. How is Christian hope different from wishful thinking?

3. How can this group live as people of hope?

UNIT 5

Faith and Science Together

"Great are the works of the Lord; they are pondered by all who delight in them." -
Psalm 111:2

Unit Overview

Many teens are told they must choose faith or science. This unit shows how they can work together and how to handle honest questions.

DEVOTIONAL

Two Books

Christians have long spoken of two 'books' from God: Scripture and nature. Both are worth studying.

PSALM 111:2

"Great are the works of the Lord; they are pondered by all who delight in them."

Studying how the world works can be an act of worship, not a threat to faith. Many great scientists were believers.

You don't have to fear questions. A faith that can't be questioned is a faith that can't grow.

Reflect

1. Have you felt you had to choose between faith and science? Where did that come from?

2. How might studying science actually deepen your worship?

PRAYER PROMPT

God, help me love truth wherever I find it and never fear honest questions.

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - OBSERVE

Wisdom and Understanding

Read the passage slowly, more than once. First notice what it actually says before deciding what it means.

PROVERBS 25:2

"It is the glory of God to conceal a matter; to search out a matter is the glory of kings."

Observation - What does it say?

1. What is God's glory in this verse?

2. What is the 'glory of kings'?

3. What does this say about investigating the world?

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - INTERPRET & APPLY

Wisdom and Understanding

Interpretation - What does it mean?

1. How does this verse dignify curiosity and investigation?

2. Why might God 'conceal' things for us to discover?

Application - What will I do?

1. What are you curious about that you've been afraid to explore?

2. How can curiosity be part of your faith?

WORD STUDY

Wisdom

MEANING

Skill in living well according to God's truth; the right use of knowledge, including knowledge of the world.

Where It Appears**PROVERBS 9:10**

"The fear of the Lord is the beginning of wisdom."

JAMES 1:5

"If any of you lacks wisdom, you should ask God."

Dig Deeper

1. How is wisdom more than just information?

2. Where do you need to ask God for wisdom right now?

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

My Questions About Faith and Science

What science-and-faith questions do you have?

Who could help you explore them well?

What would it look like to hold faith and honest inquiry together?

APPLICATION CHALLENGE

Investigate Well

Faith welcomes honest investigation. Practice it.

This Week's Challenges

- ☐ Write down your biggest faith-and-science question.
- ☐ Ask a knowledgeable Christian adult about it.
- ☐ Read one thoughtful resource on the topic.
- ☐ Thank God for the wonder of the natural world this week.

What happened when you tried?

UNIT 6

Worshiping the Creator

"You are worthy... for you created all things." - Revelation 4:11

Unit Overview

The right response to creation isn't just information but worship. This unit turns the study into praise and a way of life.

DEVOTIONAL

From Study to Worship

The point of studying creation isn't to win arguments; it's to know and worship the Creator.

ROMANS 1:20

"For since the creation of the world God's invisible qualities... have been clearly seen, being understood from what has been made."

Creation is a signpost. If you stop at the sign and never follow it to God, you've missed the point.

Worship is the natural response of a creature who realizes how good and great the Creator is.

Reflect

1. Do you tend to stop at the 'signpost' or follow it to God?

2. How could your daily life become more worshipful?

PRAYER PROMPT

Creator God, let everything I learn lead me to worship you.

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - OBSERVE

Worthy of Worship

Read the passage slowly, more than once. First notice what it actually says before deciding what it means.

REVELATION 4:11

"You are worthy, our Lord and God, to receive glory and honor and power, for you created all things, and by your will they were created and have their being."

Observation - What does it say?

1. What is God worthy to receive?

2. Why is he worthy?

3. By whose will do all things exist?

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - INTERPRET & APPLY

Worthy of Worship

Interpretation - What does it mean?

1. Why is being Creator a reason for worship?

2. What does it mean that things exist 'by his will'?

Application - What will I do?

1. What would it look like to give God 'glory, honor, and power' this week?

2. Where do you withhold worship?

WORD STUDY

Worship

MEANING

Ascribing worth to God - with our words, choices, and whole lives, not just music.

Where It Appears

ROMANS 12:1

"Offer your bodies as a living sacrifice... this is your true and proper worship."

PSALM 96:9

"Worship the Lord in the splendor of his holiness."

Dig Deeper

1. How is worship more than singing?

2. How can ordinary life - study, work, rest - become worship?

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

A Life of Worship

What has this study taught you about the Creator?

How will you respond with worship, not just knowledge?

Write a prayer of praise to the Creator.

SMALL GROUP DISCUSSION**Commissioned**

Final discussion. Study should end in worship.

1. How has studying creation affected your view of God?

2. How can your whole life be worship, not just church?

3. How can this group encourage a lifestyle of worship?

MEMORY & MEDITATION

Hide This Word in Your Heart

GENESIS 1:1

"Genesis 1:1"

Context

Look back over the verses you studied in this book.

Why It Matters

Scripture memorized becomes a resource the Holy Spirit can bring to mind in real moments of decision, temptation, doubt, and encouragement.

Write It From Memory

LIVE IT OUT THIS WEEK

Choose one verse from this book to carry with you all week.

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

Memory Verse Review

Write out from memory: Genesis 1:1

Write out from memory: Genesis 1:27

Write out from memory: Romans 8:22

Write out from memory: Revelation 21:5

Write out from memory: Psalm 19:1

SELF-ASSESSMENT

Spiritual Check-In

Rate each statement honestly. This is between you and God - there are no wrong answers, only honest starting points.

1 = rarely 5 = consistently

I make time to read the Bible on my own.

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

I pray about real things in my life, not just at meals.

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

I can explain what I believe and why.

1	2	3	4	5
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I treat people the way Jesus would.

1	2	3	4	5
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I invite God into my decisions before I make them.

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I am honest even when it costs me.

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

I serve others without expecting anything back.

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

I go to God first when I am anxious or afraid.

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

Final Reflection

How has this study changed how you see the world?

How will you respond to the Creator?

Write a prayer of worship to the God who made all things.

NOTES

Study Notes

NOTES

Study Notes



FAITH FOUNDATIONS STUDY SERIES

Prayer, Faith & Gratitude Study Workbook

Learning to Talk Honestly With God and Live Thankfully - For Ages
13-19

Written by Daniel Tesfamariam



Ages 13-19 - Homeschool & Youth Groups

Personal Study - Small Groups - Reproducible for one household or class



HOW TO USE THIS STUDY

Getting the Most From This Workbook

Prayer can feel awkward, boring, or pointless - until you understand what it actually is. This six-unit study teaches honest prayer, trusting God's answers, and a grateful heart that resists the constant discontent of comparison culture. Practical, honest, and rooted in Scripture. For ages 13 to 19.

PHILIPPIANS 4:6

"Do not be anxious about anything, but in every situation... present your requests to God."

A Few Suggestions

- ☐ Find a consistent time and place. Even 15 focused minutes beats an hour you never start.
- ☐ Keep a pen in hand. Writing your answers turns reading into real thinking.
- ☐ Read each passage in your own Bible too, and note the version differences.
- ☐ Be honest in the reflection and journal sections - no one is grading you.
- ☐ If you meet with a group, come having already written your answers.
- ☐ Pray before you begin. Ask God to teach you, not just inform you.

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UNIT 1

What Prayer Really Is

"Lord, teach us to pray." - Luke 11:1

Unit Overview

Prayer is not a performance or a formula; it's honest conversation with a God who listens. This unit reframes prayer as relationship.

DEVOTIONAL

Talking With God

The disciples didn't ask Jesus to teach them to preach or do miracles first. They asked him to teach them to pray.

LUKE 11:1

"One day Jesus was praying in a certain place. When he finished, one of his disciples said to him, 'Lord, teach us to pray.'"

Prayer isn't reciting the right words; it's relating to a real Person who already knows and loves you.

If even Jesus needed regular prayer, we shouldn't treat it as optional or advanced.

Reflect

1. What has prayer felt like for you - duty, awkward, real, or rare?

2. What would change if you saw prayer as conversation, not performance?

PRAYER PROMPT

God, teach me to pray. I want to actually talk with you.

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - OBSERVE

A Model for Prayer

Read the passage slowly, more than once. First notice what it actually says before deciding what it means.

MATTHEW 6:9-13

"This, then, is how you should pray: 'Our Father in heaven, hallowed be your name, your kingdom come, your will be done, on earth as it is in heaven. Give us today our daily bread. And forgive us our debts, as we also have forgiven our debtors. And lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from the evil one.'"

Observation - What does it say?

1. How does the prayer begin - who is addressed?

2. List the different things this prayer asks for.

3. What comes before the requests?

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - INTERPRET & APPLY

A Model for Prayer

Interpretation - What does it mean?

1. Why does Jesus start with God's name and kingdom before our needs?

2. What does this teach about prayer's priorities?

Application - What will I do?

1. Which line of this prayer do you most need to pray?

2. How could you use this as a pattern this week?

WORD STUDY

Prayer

MEANING

Communication with God - praise, thanks, confession, and requests - in an ongoing relationship.

Where It Appears**1 THESSALONIANS 5:17**

"Pray continually."

JAMES 5:16

"The prayer of a righteous person is powerful and effective."

Dig Deeper

1. What does 'pray continually' look like in a normal day?

2. What keeps you from praying more?

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

My Prayer Life

Describe your current prayer life honestly.

What do you wish were different?

What's one small change you could make?

FAITH & WORLDVIEW

Does Prayer Even Do Anything?

THE QUESTION

If God already knows everything, why pray?

Think It Through**Relationship, not vending machine**

Prayer's main purpose is knowing God, not just getting things.

God invites participation

Scripture says God genuinely works through the prayers of his people.

It changes us

Prayer reshapes our desires and perspective, not just our circumstances.

Your Response

1. Which purpose of prayer surprises you most?

2. What honest question about prayer do you still have?

UNIT 2

Praying Through Honesty

"Cast all your anxiety on him because he cares for you." - 1 Peter 5:7

Unit Overview

God can handle your real emotions. This unit explores praying through anxiety, anger, and doubt using the raw honesty of the Psalms.

DEVOTIONAL

God Can Take It

Many teens think they have to clean themselves up before praying. The Psalms say otherwise.

PSALM 13:1

"How long, Lord? Will you forget me forever? How long will you hide your face from me?"

The Bible includes prayers of grief, anger, and confusion. God isn't fragile; he invites your honesty.

Notice Psalm 13 starts with complaint and ends with trust. Honesty is often the path back to faith, not away from it.

Reflect

1. What have you felt you couldn't say to God?

2. How would it feel to bring your real emotions to him?

PRAYER PROMPT

God, thank you that you can handle my honesty. I bring you my real self.

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - OBSERVE

From Complaint to Trust

Read the passage slowly, more than once. First notice what it actually says before deciding what it means.

PSALM 13:1-2, 5-6

"How long, Lord? Will you forget me forever? How long will you hide your face from me? How long must I wrestle with my thoughts and day after day have sorrow in my heart?... But I trust in your unfailing love; my heart rejoices in your salvation. I will sing the Lord's praise, for he has been good to me."

Observation - What does it say?

1. How does David feel at the start?

2. What questions does he ask God?

3. Where does the psalm end up?

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - INTERPRET & APPLY

From Complaint to Trust

Interpretation - What does it mean?

1. Why is it healthy that this prayer includes complaint?

2. How does David move from complaint to trust?

Application - What will I do?

1. What complaint do you need to bring honestly to God?

2. Can you also name something you still trust him for?

WORD STUDY

Lament

MEANING

An honest prayer of grief or complaint to God that still trusts him.

Where It Appears**PSALM 62:8**

"Pour out your hearts to him, for God is our refuge."

PSALM 56:8

"Record my misery; list my tears on your scroll."

Dig Deeper

1. Why is lament a form of faith, not a lack of it?

2. What do you need to lament before God?

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

My Honest Prayer

What emotions are you carrying right now?

Write them out as a prayer to God.

What can you still trust God for, even now?

SMALL GROUP DISCUSSION

Talk It Over

Honesty with God is freeing. Discuss it together.

1. Why do we hide our real feelings from God?

2. How can lament actually strengthen faith?

3. How can this group pray honestly for each other?

UNIT 3

Faith That Trusts God's Answers

"Not my will, but yours be done." - Luke 22:42

Unit Overview

God answers prayer - sometimes yes, sometimes no, sometimes wait. This unit builds trust in God's wisdom even when answers differ from our wishes.

DEVOTIONAL

When the Answer Is No

Even Jesus prayed a prayer that God answered 'no' - for the sake of a greater 'yes.'

LUKE 22:42

"Father, if you are willing, take this cup from me; yet not my will, but yours be done."

Jesus honestly asked for another way, then surrendered to the Father's wisdom. Both parts matter.

An unanswered prayer isn't an unheard prayer. Sometimes God's 'no' protects a bigger 'yes' we can't yet see.

Reflect

1. When has God answered your prayer differently than you wanted?

2. How do you respond when the answer is 'no' or 'wait'?

PRAYER PROMPT

God, help me trust your wisdom even when your answer isn't what I wanted.

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - OBSERVE

Ask, Seek, Knock

Read the passage slowly, more than once. First notice what it actually says before deciding what it means.

MATTHEW 7:7-11

"Ask and it will be given to you; seek and you will find; knock and the door will be opened to you... Which of you, if your son asks for bread, will give him a stone? ... If you, then, though you are evil, know how to give good gifts to your children, how much more will your Father in heaven give good gifts to those who ask him!"

Observation - What does it say?

1. What three actions does Jesus urge?

2. What comparison does he make with parents?

3. What does the Father give?

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - INTERPRET & APPLY

Ask, Seek, Knock

Interpretation - What does it mean?

1. What does 'good gifts' suggest about how God answers?

2. How does a loving parent sometimes say no?

Application - What will I do?

1. What have you stopped asking God for?

2. How does trusting God as a good Father change your requests?

WORD STUDY

Trust

MEANING

Confident reliance on God's character and wisdom, even when circumstances confuse us.

Where It Appears**PROVERBS 3:5-6**

"Trust in the Lord with all your heart and lean not on your own understanding."

ROMANS 8:28

"We know that in all things God works for the good of those who love him."

Dig Deeper

1. Why is trust hardest when we don't understand?

2. Where do you need to 'lean not on your own understanding'?

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

Trusting the Answer

What are you praying for right now?

Could you trust God if the answer were 'no' or 'wait'?

Write a prayer of surrender like Jesus prayed.

APPLICATION CHALLENGE

Pray and Trust

Faith grows as we pray and then trust. Try these.

This Week's Challenges

- ☐ Pray daily about one specific need this week.
- ☐ Write down how God answers over time.
- ☐ Practice adding 'your will be done' to your requests.
- ☐ Thank God for a past 'no' that turned out to be for the best.

What happened when you tried?

UNIT 4

A Grateful Heart

"Give thanks in all circumstances." - 1 Thessalonians 5:18

Unit Overview

Gratitude reorients us from what we lack to what we've been given. This unit builds thankfulness as a discipline, not just a feeling.

DEVOTIONAL

The Antidote to Discontent

Comparison and complaint come naturally; gratitude has to be practiced. But it changes everything.

1 THESSALONIANS 5:18

"Give thanks in all circumstances; for this is God's will for you in Christ Jesus."

Notice it says 'in all circumstances,' not 'for all circumstances.' Gratitude isn't pretending everything is good; it's finding God's gifts even in hard seasons.

A grateful heart is the antidote to the constant discontent that social media feeds.

Reflect

1. What are you tempted to complain about right now?

2. What could you thank God for even in that situation?

PRAYER PROMPT

God, grow a grateful heart in me, even in hard circumstances.

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - OBSERVE

Thankful Even Then

Read the passage slowly, more than once. First notice what it actually says before deciding what it means.

PHILIPPIANS 4:6-7

"Do not be anxious about anything, but in every situation, by prayer and petition, with thanksgiving, present your requests to God. And the peace of God, which transcends all understanding, will guard your hearts and your minds in Christ Jesus."

Observation - What does it say?

1. What are we told not to do?

2. What are we to do instead, and with what attitude?

3. What is promised as a result?

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - INTERPRET & APPLY

Thankful Even Then

Interpretation - What does it mean?

1. Why does Paul connect thanksgiving with anxiety?

2. How does gratitude affect worry?

Application - What will I do?

1. What anxiety do you need to turn into prayer with thanksgiving?

2. How could gratitude guard your heart this week?

WORD STUDY

Gratitude

MEANING

A thankful recognition of God's goodness and gifts, expressed to him and others.

Where It Appears

PSALM 107:1

"Give thanks to the Lord, for he is good; his love endures forever."

HEBREWS 12:28

"Let us be thankful, and so worship God acceptably."

Dig Deeper

1. How is gratitude a choice as much as a feeling?

2. Who in your life deserves your thanks that you rarely express?

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

Counting Gifts

List ten things you're grateful for today.

What blessing do you usually take for granted?

Write a prayer of thanks to God.

SMALL GROUP DISCUSSION

Talk It Over

Gratitude is countercultural. Discuss how to grow it.

1. Why is our culture so prone to discontent?

2. How does gratitude change your outlook?

3. How can this group cultivate thankfulness together?

UNIT 5

Prayer as a Daily Rhythm

"Very early in the morning... Jesus... went off to a solitary place, where he prayed."

- Mark 1:35

Unit Overview

Great prayer lives are built on small habits. This unit helps establish a sustainable, personal rhythm of prayer and Bible reading.

DEVOTIONAL

Building the Habit

Jesus, the busiest and most important person ever, still made space to pray. If he needed rhythm, so do we.

MARK 1:35

"Very early in the morning, while it was still dark, Jesus got up, left the house and went off to a solitary place, where he prayed."

Notice the intentionality: early, solitary, prioritized. Prayer didn't just happen; Jesus made room for it.

You don't need hours. You need consistency. A small daily rhythm beats occasional marathons.

Reflect

1. When and where could you realistically pray each day?

2. What usually crowds out your time with God?

PRAYER PROMPT

God, help me build a real, sustainable rhythm of time with you.

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - OBSERVE

Devoted to Prayer

Read the passage slowly, more than once. First notice what it actually says before deciding what it means.

COLOSSIANS 4:2

"Devote yourselves to prayer, being watchful and thankful."

Observation - What does it say?

1. What are we told to devote ourselves to?

2. What two attitudes accompany it?

3. What does 'devote' imply?

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - INTERPRET & APPLY

Devoted to Prayer

Interpretation - What does it mean?

1. What's the difference between occasional prayer and devotion to prayer?

2. How do watchfulness and thankfulness shape prayer?

Application - What will I do?

1. What would 'devotion' to prayer look like in your life?

2. How can you be more watchful and thankful?

WORD STUDY

Devotion

MEANING

Committed, consistent love expressed through regular time and attention.

Where It Appears

ACTS 2:42

"They devoted themselves to... prayer."

2 CORINTHIANS 11:3

"But I am afraid that... your minds may somehow be led astray from your sincere and pure devotion to Christ."

Dig Deeper

1. What does devotion to a person or goal usually require?

2. How could your devotion to Christ grow more consistent?

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

My Rhythm

When will you spend time with God each day?

What will you do in that time (read, pray, journal)?

What obstacle will you plan around?

APPLICATION CHALLENGE

Seven Days of Prayer

Rhythm is built by repetition. Commit to a week.

This Week's Challenges

- ☐ Pray at the same time each day for seven days.
- ☐ Keep a short prayer journal each day.
- ☐ Include praise, thanks, confession, and requests.
- ☐ Note one thing God does or teaches you.

What happened when you tried?

UNIT 6

Praying for Others and the World

"I urge... that petitions, prayers, intercession and thanksgiving be made for all people." - 1 Timothy 2:1

Unit Overview

Mature prayer looks outward. This unit moves from self-focused prayer to interceding for others, the church, and the world.

DEVOTIONAL

Beyond Myself

Prayer that only ever says 'help me' stays small. Prayer grows up when it starts carrying others.

1 TIMOTHY 2:1

"I urge, then, first of all, that petitions, prayers, intercession and thanksgiving be made for all people."

Interceding - praying for others - is one of the most loving things you can do, and one of the least visible.

As you pray for others, God often grows your compassion and softens your heart toward them.

Reflect

1. Who is God putting on your heart to pray for?

2. How might praying for others change how you feel toward them?

PRAYER PROMPT

God, grow my prayers beyond myself. Give me a heart for others and the world.

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - OBSERVE

Paul's Prayer for Others

Read the passage slowly, more than once. First notice what it actually says before deciding what it means.

EPHESIANS 3:16-19

"I pray that out of his glorious riches he may strengthen you with power through his Spirit in your inner being, so that Christ may dwell in your hearts through faith. And I pray that you, being rooted and established in love, may have power... to grasp how wide and long and high and deep is the love of Christ."

Observation - What does it say?

1. What does Paul pray others will be strengthened with?

2. What does he pray they'll grasp?

3. Who empowers this?

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - INTERPRET & APPLY

Paul's Prayer for Others

Interpretation - What does it mean?

1. How is Paul's prayer different from just praying for people's comfort?

2. What does he most want for others?

Application - What will I do?

1. How could you pray this kind of prayer for someone?

2. Who needs you to pray for their inner strength?

WORD STUDY

Intercession

MEANING

Praying on behalf of others, standing in the gap for their needs before God.

Where It Appears

ROMANS 8:34

"Christ Jesus... is also interceding for us."

JAMES 5:16

"Pray for each other so that you may be healed."

Dig Deeper

1. What does it mean that Jesus himself intercedes for you?

2. Who could you commit to intercede for regularly?

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

My Prayer List

List people and situations you want to pray for.

What is the most important thing this study taught you about prayer?

Write a prayer for someone other than yourself.

SMALL GROUP DISCUSSION

Commissioned

Final discussion. Prayer is meant to grow outward.

1. How can we keep prayer from becoming all about ourselves?

2. What's your plan to keep praying after this book?

3. How can this group pray for each other going forward?

MEMORY & MEDITATION

Hide This Word in Your Heart

LUKE 11:1

"Luke 11:1"

Context

Look back over the verses you studied in this book.

Why It Matters

Scripture memorized becomes a resource the Holy Spirit can bring to mind in real moments of decision, temptation, doubt, and encouragement.

Write It From Memory

LIVE IT OUT THIS WEEK

Choose one verse from this book to carry with you all week.

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

Memory Verse Review

Write out from memory: Luke 11:1

Write out from memory: 1 Peter 5:7

Write out from memory: Luke 22:42

Write out from memory: 1 Thessalonians 5:18

Write out from memory: Philippians 4:6

SELF-ASSESSMENT

Spiritual Check-In

Rate each statement honestly. This is between you and God - there are no wrong answers, only honest starting points.

1 = rarely 5 = consistently

I make time to read the Bible on my own.

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I am honest even when it costs me.

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---	---	---	---	---

I serve others without expecting anything back.

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---	---	---	---	---

I go to God first when I am anxious or afraid.

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

Final Reflection

How has your view of prayer changed through this study?

What prayer habit will you keep?

Write a prayer of thanks and commitment.

NOTES

Study Notes

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Study Notes



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HOW TO USE THIS STUDY

Getting the Most From This Workbook

This isn't busywork memorization - it's building a reservoir of truth you can draw on when life gets hard, decisions get big, and lies get loud. Across six units you'll memorize and meditate on verses about identity, anxiety, guidance, and the gospel, and build a habit that lasts for life. For ages 13 to 19.

PSALM 119:11

"Your word I have hidden in my heart, that I might not sin against you."

A Few Suggestions

- ☐ Find a consistent time and place. Even 15 focused minutes beats an hour you never start.
- ☐ Keep a pen in hand. Writing your answers turns reading into real thinking.
- ☐ Read each passage in your own Bible too, and note the version differences.
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UNIT 1

Why Memorize Scripture

"I have hidden your word in my heart that I might not sin against you." - Psalm 119:11

Unit Overview

Memorized Scripture becomes a resource the Spirit can use in real moments. This unit makes the case and starts building the habit.

DEVOTIONAL

Word in the Heart

You can't always open a Bible mid-conversation, mid-temptation, or mid-panic. Memorized Scripture goes with you.

PSALM 119:11

"I have hidden your word in my heart that I might not sin against you."

Scripture memorized is Scripture available - in the moment you need truth, comfort, or strength.

This isn't about impressing anyone. It's about having God's words ready when life gets loud.

Reflect

1. When have you needed truth or comfort but couldn't recall any?

2. What might change if key verses were in your memory?

PRAYER PROMPT

God, help me hide your word in my heart so it's there when I need it.

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - OBSERVE

The Word Near You

Read the passage slowly, more than once. First notice what it actually says before deciding what it means.

DEUTERONOMY 6:6-9

"These commandments that I give you today are to be on your hearts. Impress them on your children. Talk about them when you sit at home and when you walk along the road, when you lie down and when you get up. Tie them as symbols on your hands and bind them on your foreheads."

Observation - What does it say?

1. Where are the commandments to be first?

2. When are they to be talked about?

3. How thoroughly are they to fill life?

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - INTERPRET & APPLY

The Word Near You

Interpretation - What does it mean?

1. Why does God want his word woven into everyday moments?

2. What does it mean to have Scripture 'on your heart'?

Application - What will I do?

1. When in your day could you review Scripture?

2. How could God's word be more woven into your routine?

WORD STUDY

Meditation

MEANING

To turn God's word over in your mind repeatedly until it shapes your thinking and living.

Where It Appears**PSALM 1:1-2**

"Blessed is the one who... meditates on his law day and night."

JOSHUA 1:8

"Keep this Book of the Law always on your lips; meditate on it day and night."

Dig Deeper

1. How does memorizing enable meditation?

2. What's one verse you'd like to 'chew on' this week?

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

My Starting Point

How many verses can you recall right now?

Why do you want to memorize Scripture?

What's your plan to start?

FAITH & WORLDVIEW

Isn't Memorizing Just Rote?

THE QUESTION

Does memorizing verses actually help, or is it empty repetition?

Think It Through**Raw material for the Spirit**

You can't be reminded of what you never learned; memory gives the Spirit something to use.

Meditation needs memory

Deep reflection is easier when the words are already inside you.

Understanding matters

Memorize with meaning, not just sounds, and it becomes formation, not rote.

Your Response

1. Have you dismissed memorization as pointless? Why?

2. How could you memorize with understanding, not just repetition?

UNIT 2

Verses on Identity

"See what great love the Father has lavished on us, that we should be called children of God!" - 1 John 3:1

Unit Overview

This unit memorizes and meditates on verses that answer 'Who am I?' - anchoring identity in God rather than performance or approval.

DEVOTIONAL

Named and Loved

The world hands out identities based on performance. God hands out a name based on love.

1 JOHN 3:1

"See what great love the Father has lavished on us, that we should be called children of God! And that is what we are!"

Your deepest identity isn't 'student,' 'athlete,' or 'popular.' It's 'child of God' - lavishly loved.

Memorizing identity verses gives you truth to reach for when lies about your worth get loud.

Reflect

1. What identities do you cling to for worth?

2. How does 'child of God' reframe those?

PRAYER PROMPT

God, help me believe and remember that I'm your lavishly loved child.

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - OBSERVE

A Chosen People

Read the passage slowly, more than once. First notice what it actually says before deciding what it means.

1 PETER 2:9

"But you are a chosen people, a royal priesthood, a holy nation, God's special possession, that you may declare the praises of him who called you out of darkness into his wonderful light."

Observation - What does it say?

1. List every identity phrase Peter uses.

2. What were we called out of and into?

3. What's the purpose of this identity?

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - INTERPRET & APPLY

A Chosen People

Interpretation - What does it mean?

1. Why does Peter pile up so many identity terms?

2. How does this identity come with purpose?

Application - What will I do?

1. Which phrase do you most need to believe?

2. How does this identity give you a mission?

WORD STUDY

Adoption

MEANING

God's act of making believers his own children, with full belonging and inheritance.

Where It Appears**ROMANS 8:15**

"The Spirit you received brought about your adoption to sonship. And by him we cry, 'Abba, Father.'"

EPHESIANS 1:4-5

"In love he predestined us for adoption to sonship through Jesus Christ."

Dig Deeper

1. What does adoption say about how God sees you?

2. How is being adopted different from being tolerated?

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

Memorize It

Write 1 Peter 2:9 from memory (try after practicing).

Which identity phrase means the most to you, and why?

How will you preach this to yourself this week?

SMALL GROUP DISCUSSION

Talk It Over

Identity is a battleground. Anchor it together.

1. Where do people our age look for identity?

2. How can memorized truth fight identity lies?

3. How can this group remind each other who they are?

UNIT 3

Verses for Anxiety and Fear

"When anxiety was great within me, your consolation brought me joy." - Psalm 94:19

Unit Overview

Anxiety is common among teens. This unit memorizes verses that provide truth and comfort to reach for in anxious moments.

DEVOTIONAL

Truth for the Spiral

Anxiety often lies loudly. Memorized truth is how you talk back with something stronger than your fears.

1 PETER 5:7

"Cast all your anxiety on him because he cares for you."

When anxiety spirals, you rarely have time to search for a verse. Memorized truth is already there to reach for.

God doesn't dismiss your anxiety; he invites you to cast it on him because he genuinely cares.

Reflect

1. What tends to trigger your anxiety?

2. How could a memorized verse help in those moments?

PRAYER PROMPT

God, when anxiety rises, remind me you care and help me cast it on you.

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - OBSERVE

Peace That Guards

Read the passage slowly, more than once. First notice what it actually says before deciding what it means.

PHILIPPIANS 4:6-8

"Do not be anxious about anything, but in every situation, by prayer and petition, with thanksgiving, present your requests to God. And the peace of God, which transcends all understanding, will guard your hearts and your minds in Christ Jesus. Finally, brothers and sisters, whatever is true... noble... right... think about such things."

Observation - What does it say?

1. What's the alternative to anxiety here?

2. What's promised to guard our hearts and minds?

3. What are we told to think about?

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - INTERPRET & APPLY

Peace That Guards

Interpretation - What does it mean?

1. How does what we think about affect anxiety?

2. Why 'guard' - what's the image?

Application - What will I do?

1. What true, noble, right things could you dwell on instead of fears?

2. What request will you bring to God?

WORD STUDY

Peace

MEANING

Wholeness and calm rooted in a right relationship with God, not the absence of problems.

Where It Appears**JOHN 14:27**

"Peace I leave with you; my peace I give you."

ISAIAH 26:3

"You will keep in perfect peace those whose minds are steadfast, because they trust in you."

Dig Deeper

1. How is God's peace different from the world's?

2. How does trust relate to peace in Isaiah 26:3?

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

My Anchor Verses

What anxiety do you carry most?

Which verse from this unit will you memorize for it?

Write it out and personalize it as a prayer.

APPLICATION CHALLENGE

Memorize for the Moment

Prepare truth before you need it. Practice this week.

This Week's Challenges

- ☐ Memorize one anxiety verse fully this week.
- ☐ Recite it when you feel anxious.
- ☐ Turn it into a prayer each morning.
- ☐ Share it with someone else who struggles.

What happened when you tried?

UNIT 4

Verses on Guidance and Decisions

"Your word is a lamp for my feet, a light on my path." - Psalm 119:105

Unit Overview

Teens face big decisions. This unit memorizes verses about wisdom and guidance to shape how you make choices.

DEVOTIONAL

A Lamp, Not a Spotlight

God's word is described as a lamp for your feet - enough light for the next step, not a floodlight on the whole future.

PSALM 119:105

"Your word is a lamp for my feet, a light on my path."

We want God to show us the whole plan. He usually gives enough light for the next faithful step.

Memorizing guidance verses helps you make decisions by God's wisdom rather than just feelings or pressure.

Reflect

1. What decision are you facing right now?

2. How might God's word guide your next step?

PRAYER PROMPT

God, light my next step and help me trust you with the rest.

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - OBSERVE

Trust and He Directs

Read the passage slowly, more than once. First notice what it actually says before deciding what it means.

PROVERBS 3:5-6

"Trust in the Lord with all your heart and lean not on your own understanding; in all your ways submit to him, and he will make your paths straight."

Observation - What does it say?

1. What are we told to trust, and how fully?

2. What are we told not to lean on?

3. What's the promise?

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - INTERPRET & APPLY

Trust and He Directs

Interpretation - What does it mean?

1. What does it mean to 'submit in all your ways'?

2. How is this different from just doing what feels right?

Application - What will I do?

1. Where are you leaning on your own understanding?

2. What would submitting a decision to God look like?

WORD STUDY

Wisdom

MEANING

Skill in living well according to God's truth; making good decisions in light of who God is.

Where It Appears**JAMES 1:5**

"If any of you lacks wisdom, you should ask God."

PROVERBS 9:10

"The fear of the Lord is the beginning of wisdom."

Dig Deeper

1. How do you seek wisdom for decisions now?

2. What decision do you need to 'ask God' about?

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

Decisions Ahead

What decisions are on your horizon?

Which verse will guide you?

Write a prayer asking God for wisdom.

SMALL GROUP DISCUSSION

Talk It Over

Decisions are better made with wisdom and community.

1. How do people our age usually make big decisions?

2. How can Scripture shape decision-making?

3. How can this group help each other decide wisely?

UNIT 5

Verses About the Gospel

"For God so loved the world that he gave his one and only Son." - John 3:16

Unit Overview

This unit memorizes core gospel verses so you can know, believe, and share the good news clearly.

DEVOTIONAL

The Good News, Memorized

If someone asked you to explain the gospel right now, could you? Memorized gospel verses make you ready.

JOHN 3:16

"For God so loved the world that he gave his one and only Son, that whoever believes in him shall not perish but have eternal life."

The most famous verse in the Bible packs the whole gospel: God's love, Jesus' gift, our belief, eternal life.

Knowing gospel verses lets you both rest in grace yourself and explain it to others.

Reflect

1. Could you explain the gospel simply right now?

2. Which part of John 3:16 means the most to you?

PRAYER PROMPT

God, help me know and treasure the gospel, and be ready to share it.

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - OBSERVE

Saved by Grace

Read the passage slowly, more than once. First notice what it actually says before deciding what it means.

EPHESIANS 2:8-9

"For it is by grace you have been saved, through faith - and this is not from yourselves, it is the gift of God - not by works, so that no one can boast."

Observation - What does it say?

1. How are we saved?

2. Where does it come from?

3. What can no one do as a result?

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - INTERPRET & APPLY

Saved by Grace

Interpretation - What does it mean?

1. Why does it matter that salvation is a gift, not earned?

2. What does this protect us from?

Application - What will I do?

1. Where do you still try to 'earn' God's acceptance?

2. How does grace free you?

WORD STUDY

Gospel

MEANING

The good news that God saves sinners through the life, death, and resurrection of Jesus.

Where It Appears**ROMANS 1:16**

"I am not ashamed of the gospel, because it is the power of God that brings salvation."

1 CORINTHIANS 15:3-4

"Christ died for our sins... was buried... was raised on the third day."

Dig Deeper

1. How would you summarize the gospel in a few sentences?

2. Why is the gospel called 'the power of God'?

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

The Gospel in My Words

Write the gospel in your own words.

Which verse best captures it for you?

Who could you share it with?

APPLICATION CHALLENGE

Be Ready

Memorize the gospel so you can share it. Try these.

This Week's Challenges

- ☐ Memorize John 3:16 and Ephesians 2:8-9 this week.
- ☐ Write out the gospel in your own words.
- ☐ Practice explaining it to a friend or family member.
- ☐ Thank God for the gift of salvation daily.

What happened when you tried?

UNIT 6

A Lifelong Habit

"Let the message of Christ dwell among you richly." - Colossians 3:16

Unit Overview

The goal is a lifelong habit, not a one-time push. This unit builds a personal system for ongoing memory and meditation.

DEVOTIONAL

Dwelling Richly

Scripture memory isn't a season to finish; it's a habit to keep for life - letting God's word 'dwell richly' in you.

COLOSSIANS 3:16

"Let the message of Christ dwell among you richly as you teach and admonish one another with all wisdom."

'Dwell richly' means God's word isn't a guest that visits occasionally but a resident that fills your home.

Small, steady review over years builds a deep reservoir of truth you'll draw on for a lifetime.

Reflect

1. What system could help you keep memorizing long-term?

2. How could God's word 'dwell richly' in your daily life?

PRAYER PROMPT

God, make your word a permanent resident in me, not an occasional guest.

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - OBSERVE

Storing Up Treasure

Read the passage slowly, more than once. First notice what it actually says before deciding what it means.

MATTHEW 13:52

"He said to them, 'Therefore every teacher of the law who has become a disciple in the kingdom of heaven is like the owner of a house who brings out of his storeroom new treasures as well as old.'"

Observation - What does it say?

1. What is the disciple compared to?

2. What does the owner bring out?

3. Where do these treasures come from?

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - INTERPRET & APPLY

Storing Up Treasure

Interpretation - What does it mean?

1. How is memorized Scripture like a 'storeroom' of treasure?

2. Why value both 'new and old'?

Application - What will I do?

1. What 'treasure' have you stored up so far?

2. How will you keep adding to it?

WORD STUDY

Discipleship

MEANING

A lifelong process of following and learning from Jesus, shaped by his word.

Where It Appears**JOHN 8:31**

"If you hold to my teaching, you are really my disciples."

2 PETER 3:18

"Grow in the grace and knowledge of our Lord and Savior Jesus Christ."

Dig Deeper

1. How does Scripture memory fit into lifelong discipleship?

2. What habit will you carry beyond this book?

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

My Lifelong Plan

What's your plan to keep memorizing Scripture?

Which verses from this book will you keep reviewing?

Write a prayer of commitment.

SMALL GROUP DISCUSSION

Commissioned

Final discussion. This is a lifelong habit, not a finish line.

1. What's been the hardest and best part of memorizing?

2. How will you keep going after this book?

3. How can this group keep each other accountable?

MEMORY & MEDITATION

Hide This Word in Your Heart

PSALM 119:11

"Psalm 119:11"

Context

Look back over the verses you studied in this book.

Why It Matters

Scripture memorized becomes a resource the Holy Spirit can bring to mind in real moments of decision, temptation, doubt, and encouragement.

Write It From Memory

LIVE IT OUT THIS WEEK

Choose one verse from this book to carry with you all week.

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

Memory Verse Review

Write out from memory: Psalm 119:11

Write out from memory: 1 Peter 2:9

Write out from memory: Philippians 4:6-7

Write out from memory: Proverbs 3:5-6

Write out from memory: John 3:16

SELF-ASSESSMENT

Spiritual Check-In

Rate each statement honestly. This is between you and God - there are no wrong answers, only honest starting points.

1 = rarely 5 = consistently

I make time to read the Bible on my own.

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

I pray about real things in my life, not just at meals.

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

I can explain what I believe and why.

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

I treat people the way Jesus would.

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

I invite God into my decisions before I make them.

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

I am honest even when it costs me.

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

I serve others without expecting anything back.

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

I go to God first when I am anxious or afraid.

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

Final Reflection

Which memorized verse has become most meaningful?

How has hiding God's word in your heart affected you?

Write a prayer committing to keep memorizing.

NOTES

Study Notes

NOTES

Study Notes



FAITH FOUNDATIONS STUDY SERIES

Owning Your Faith: A Study Workbook

Moving From Inherited Belief to Personal, Living Faith - For New & Growing Believers, Ages 13-19

Written by Daniel Tesfamariam



Ages 13-19 - Homeschool & Youth Groups

Personal Study - Small Groups - Reproducible for one household or class

HOW TO USE THIS STUDY

Getting the Most From This Workbook

There comes a point when faith has to stop being your parents' or your church's and start being yours. This six-unit study is for teens and young adults ready to own their faith: making it personal, growing up spiritually, living it in real relationships and culture, discovering purpose, and living sent. For ages 13 to 19.

2 TIMOTHY 3:14

"Continue in what you have learned and have become convinced of."

A Few Suggestions

- ☐ Find a consistent time and place. Even 15 focused minutes beats an hour you never start.
- ☐ Keep a pen in hand. Writing your answers turns reading into real thinking.
- ☐ Read each passage in your own Bible too, and note the version differences.
- ☐ Be honest in the reflection and journal sections - no one is grading you.
- ☐ If you meet with a group, come having already written your answers.
- ☐ Pray before you begin. Ask God to teach you, not just inform you.

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UNIT 1

Making It Personal

"Whoever has the Son has life." - 1 John 5:12

Unit Overview

You can grow up around faith without ever making it your own. This unit is about the difference between inherited belief and personal faith.

DEVOTIONAL

Inherited or Owned?

Faith can't be passed down like a family recipe. At some point it has to become yours.

ROMANS 8:15

"For you did not receive a spirit that makes you a slave again to fear, but the Spirit you received brought about your adoption to sonship."

Growing up in a Christian home is a gift, but God has no grandchildren - only children. Faith has to be personal.

Owning your faith doesn't mean throwing out what you were taught; it means truly making it your own conviction.

Reflect

1. Is your faith currently more inherited or more owned?

2. What would it look like to make it truly yours?

PRAYER PROMPT

God, I don't want a borrowed faith. Help me make it my own.

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - OBSERVE

Choose This Day

Read the passage slowly, more than once. First notice what it actually says before deciding what it means.

JOSHUA 24:14-15

"Now fear the Lord and serve him with all faithfulness... But if serving the Lord seems undesirable to you, then choose for yourselves this day whom you will serve... But as for me and my household, we will serve the Lord."

Observation - What does it say?

1. What does Joshua call the people to do?

2. What choice does he lay before them?

3. What does Joshua personally decide?

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - INTERPRET & APPLY

Choose This Day

Interpretation - What does it mean?

1. Why does Joshua force a clear choice?

2. What does 'as for me' show about owning your decision?

Application - What will I do?

1. Have you personally chosen to follow God?

2. What would a real decision look like for you?

WORD STUDY

Faith

MEANING

Personal trust in and reliance on God - not just believing facts, but entrusting your life to him.

Where It Appears**1 JOHN 5:12**

"Whoever has the Son has life; whoever does not have the Son of God does not have life."

ACTS 16:31

"Believe in the Lord Jesus, and you will be saved."

Dig Deeper

1. What's the difference between believing about Jesus and trusting him?

2. Where are you in that difference right now?

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

My Faith Story

How did you first encounter faith?

Where are you in your own journey right now?

What would owning your faith require of you?

FAITH & WORLDVIEW

What If I Have Doubts?

THE QUESTION

Can you own a faith you still have questions about?

Think It Through**Doubt isn't the opposite of faith**

Unbelief that refuses to seek is; honest doubt that seeks can deepen faith.

Bring questions to God

God isn't threatened by your questions; hiding them is what hurts faith.

Faith and understanding grow together

You don't need every answer to take a real step of trust.

Your Response

1. What doubts do you need to stop hiding?

2. Who could help you explore them honestly?

UNIT 2

Growing Up Spiritually

"Grow in the grace and knowledge of our Lord and Savior Jesus Christ." - 2 Peter 3:18

Unit Overview

Faith is meant to mature. This unit explores what spiritual growth looks like and the practices that fuel it.

DEVOTIONAL

From Milk to Solid Food

There's nothing wrong with being a spiritual beginner - but there's a problem with staying one forever.

HEBREWS 5:13-14

"Anyone who lives on milk, being still an infant, is not acquainted with the teaching about righteousness... But solid food is for the mature."

Spiritual growth isn't automatic with time; it comes through use and practice, like building strength.

Maturity means moving from being spoon-fed to feeding yourself and eventually feeding others.

Reflect

1. Where are you in your spiritual growth - infant, growing, maturing?

2. What would help you 'grow up' in faith?

PRAYER PROMPT

God, help me grow up spiritually and not stay stuck.

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - OBSERVE

The Marks of Growth

Read the passage slowly, more than once. First notice what it actually says before deciding what it means.

2 PETER 1:5-8

"For this very reason, make every effort to add to your faith goodness; and to goodness, knowledge; and to knowledge, self-control; and to self-control, perseverance; and to perseverance, godliness; and to godliness, mutual affection; and to mutual affection, love. For if you possess these qualities in increasing measure, they will keep you from being ineffective."

Observation - What does it say?

1. What are we told to 'make every effort' to do?

2. List the qualities to add.

3. What do these qualities prevent?

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - INTERPRET & APPLY

The Marks of Growth

Interpretation - What does it mean?

1. Why does Peter say to 'make every effort' if growth is God's work?

2. How do these qualities build on each other?

Application - What will I do?

1. Which quality do you most need to grow in?

2. What effort could you make this week?

WORD STUDY

Maturity

MEANING

Spiritual growth toward Christlikeness in character, wisdom, and love.

Where It Appears**EPHESIANS 4:13**

"Until we all reach... maturity, attaining to the whole measure of the fullness of Christ."

HEBREWS 6:1

"Let us move beyond the elementary teachings about Christ and be taken forward to maturity."

Dig Deeper

1. What does spiritual maturity look like in someone you admire?

2. What's one next step toward maturity for you?

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

Growth Plan


Where have you grown spiritually in the past year?


Where are you stuck?


What practice would help you grow?

SMALL GROUP DISCUSSION

Talk It Over

Growth happens best in community. Discuss it.

1. What helps people actually grow spiritually?

2. What keeps people stuck as spiritual 'infants'?

3. How can this group spur each other's growth?

UNIT 3

Faith in Real Relationships

"By this everyone will know that you are my disciples, if you love one another." -
John 13:35

Unit Overview

Faith is tested most in relationships. This unit covers friendship, family, dating, and conflict from a Christian perspective.

DEVOTIONAL

Love Is the Test

Jesus said the mark of his followers wouldn't be their arguments or their reputation - but their love.

JOHN 13:34

"A new command I give you: Love one another. As I have loved you, so you must love one another."

It's easy to be 'spiritual' alone. Relationships reveal whether faith is real - through patience, forgiveness, and honesty.

The people closest to you experience your actual character, not your online image.

Reflect

1. Where are your relationships testing your faith right now?

2. How does the way you treat people reflect your faith?

PRAYER PROMPT

God, let my love for people show that I belong to you.

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - OBSERVE

What Love Looks Like

Read the passage slowly, more than once. First notice what it actually says before deciding what it means.

1 CORINTHIANS 13:4-7

"Love is patient, love is kind. It does not envy, it does not boast, it is not proud. It does not dishonor others, it is not self-seeking, it is not easily angered, it keeps no record of wrongs. Love does not delight in evil but rejoices with the truth. It always protects, always trusts, always hopes, always perseveres."

Observation - What does it say?

1. List what love is.

2. List what love is not.

3. What does love 'always' do?

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - INTERPRET & APPLY

What Love Looks Like

Interpretation - What does it mean?

1. Which of these is hardest to live out?

2. How is this different from how culture defines love?

Application - What will I do?

1. Which relationship needs this kind of love from you?

2. Where do you keep a 'record of wrongs'?

WORD STUDY

Love (Agape)

MEANING

Selfless, committed love that seeks another's good regardless of feelings or return.

Where It Appears**JOHN 15:13**

"Greater love has no one than this: to lay down one's life for one's friends."

1 JOHN 4:10

"This is love: not that we loved God, but that he loved us."

Dig Deeper

1. How is agape different from romantic or friendly feelings?

2. Who in your life is hard to love this way?

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

My Relationships

Which relationship is hardest for you right now?

How would Jesus have you handle it?

What's one loving step you could take?

APPLICATION CHALLENGE

Love in Action

Love is proven in action, not words. Try these.

This Week's Challenges

- ☐ Forgive someone who wronged you.
- ☐ Have a hard conversation with honesty and kindness.
- ☐ Serve a family member without being asked.
- ☐ Love someone who's hard to love this week.

What happened when you tried?

UNIT 4

Standing Firm in Culture

"Do not conform to the pattern of this world, but be transformed." - Romans 12:2

Unit Overview

Teens are immersed in messages that contradict faith. This unit builds discernment and conviction for living differently.

DEVOTIONAL

Swimming Upstream

Following Jesus often means going against the current - of your culture, your peers, sometimes your own desires.

ROMANS 12:2

"Do not conform to the pattern of this world, but be transformed by the renewing of your mind."

Culture constantly forms us, usually without our noticing. Transformation means letting God renew our thinking instead.

You can't help being influenced; you can choose what shapes you most.

Reflect

1. What cultural messages most shape how you think?

2. Where do you feel pressure to 'conform'?

PRAYER PROMPT

God, renew my mind so I'm shaped by you, not just my culture.

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - OBSERVE

In the World, Not of It

Read the passage slowly, more than once. First notice what it actually says before deciding what it means.

JOHN 17:15-18

"My prayer is not that you take them out of the world but that you protect them from the evil one. They are not of the world, even as I am not of it. Sanctify them by the truth; your word is truth... As you sent me into the world, I have sent them into the world."

Observation - What does it say?

1. What does Jesus not pray for?

2. What does he pray for instead?

3. What sanctifies (sets apart) his followers?

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - INTERPRET & APPLY

In the World, Not of It

Interpretation - What does it mean?

1. Why doesn't Jesus want us removed from the world?

2. How does truth protect and set apart?

Application - What will I do?

1. Where are you tempted to either hide from or blend into culture?

2. How can you be 'sent' into it without being 'of' it?

WORD STUDY

Discernment

MEANING

The ability to distinguish truth from error and good from evil, guided by God's word.

Where It Appears**1 THESSALONIANS 5:21**

"Test everything; hold on to what is good."

HEBREWS 5:14

"Solid food is for the mature, who... have trained themselves to distinguish good from evil."

Dig Deeper

1. How do you currently decide what's true and good?

2. Where do you need more discernment?

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

What Shapes Me

What voices influence you most (media, friends, etc.)?

Where do they conflict with your faith?

How could you renew your mind in that area?

FAITH & WORLDVIEW

Isn't It Intolerant to Say You're Right?

THE QUESTION

How can Christians hold convictions without being arrogant?

Think It Through**Everyone has convictions**

Even 'all views are equal' is itself a firm claim about truth.

Truth and kindness together

Holding a belief firmly and treating people with respect aren't opposites.

Humble confidence

Jesus was full of both grace and truth - we can be too.

Your Response

1. How can you hold convictions with humility and love?

2. Where have you seen this done well or poorly?

UNIT 5

Discovering Your Purpose

"For we are God's handiwork, created in Christ Jesus to do good works." -
Ephesians 2:10

Unit Overview

Teens constantly ask 'What am I here for?' This unit explores calling, gifts, and living with purpose.

DEVOTIONAL

Made for a Reason

You're not an accident or a spare part. You were made on purpose, for a purpose.

EPHESIANS 2:10

"For we are God's handiwork, created in Christ Jesus to do good works, which God prepared in advance for us to do."

You're God's 'handiwork' - a work of art with intention behind it. Your life has design and direction.

Purpose isn't mainly about a career; it's about who you're becoming and how you serve God and others.

Reflect

1. Have you felt purposeless or aimless? When?

2. How does being God's intentional 'handiwork' change that?

PRAYER PROMPT

God, help me discover and live the purpose you made me for.

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - OBSERVE

Different Gifts, One Body

Read the passage slowly, more than once. First notice what it actually says before deciding what it means.

ROMANS 12:4-6

"For just as each of us has one body with many members, and these members do not all have the same function, so in Christ we, though many, form one body, and each member belongs to all the others. We have different gifts, according to the grace given to each of us."

Observation - What does it say?

1. What is the body compared to?

2. Do all members have the same function?

3. Where do our gifts come from?

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - INTERPRET & APPLY

Different Gifts, One Body

Interpretation - What does it mean?

1. Why does the body need different gifts?

2. What happens if someone doesn't use their gift?

Application - What will I do?

1. What gifts or strengths do you have?

2. How could you use them to serve?

WORD STUDY

Calling

MEANING

God's purpose for your life - both the general call to follow Christ and specific ways to serve.

Where It Appears**EPHESIANS 4:1**

"Live a life worthy of the calling you have received."

COLOSSIANS 3:23

"Whatever you do, work at it with all your heart, as working for the Lord."

Dig Deeper

1. What might God be calling you toward, even now?

2. How can everyday work be done 'for the Lord'?

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

My Purpose


What are you passionate about?


What are you good at?


How might God want to use those to serve others?

SMALL GROUP DISCUSSION

Talk It Over

Purpose is discovered in community and service.

- 1.** Why do so many people feel aimless?

- 2.** How is Christian purpose different from just 'finding yourself'?

- 3.** How can this group help each other use their gifts?

UNIT 6

Living Sent

"Go and make disciples of all nations." - Matthew 28:19

Unit Overview

Faith isn't meant to be kept to yourself. This unit is about living as someone sent to reflect and share Jesus - the culmination of owning your faith.

DEVOTIONAL

You Are Sent

Owning your faith isn't the finish line; it's the starting line for a life that points others to Jesus.

MATTHEW 28:19-20

"Therefore go and make disciples of all nations... And surely I am with you always, to the very end of the age."

Jesus' final command wasn't 'keep this to yourself'; it was 'go.' You're sent right where you are.

You don't have to be an expert. You just have to point people to the One who changed you - and he's with you.

Reflect

1. Who in your life doesn't know Jesus?

2. What holds you back from sharing your faith?

PRAYER PROMPT

God, help me live sent - reflecting and sharing you wherever I am.

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - OBSERVE

Salt and Light

Read the passage slowly, more than once. First notice what it actually says before deciding what it means.

MATTHEW 5:13-16

"You are the salt of the earth... You are the light of the world. A town built on a hill cannot be hidden. Neither do people light a lamp and put it under a bowl. Instead they put it on its stand, and it gives light to everyone in the house. In the same way, let your light shine before others, that they may see your good deeds and glorify your Father in heaven."

Observation - What does it say?

1. What two things does Jesus call his followers?

2. What's the point of salt and light?

3. What's the goal of shining?

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - INTERPRET & APPLY

Salt and Light

Interpretation - What does it mean?

1. What happens to salt or light that's hidden?

2. How is influence different from being preachy?

Application - What will I do?

1. Where could your life be 'salt and light'?

2. How can your good deeds point to God, not you?

WORD STUDY

Mission

MEANING

The sending of God's people into the world to reflect and share the good news of Jesus.

Where It Appears**JOHN 20:21**

"As the Father has sent me, I am sending you."

ACTS 1:8

"You will be my witnesses."

Dig Deeper

1. How does knowing you're 'sent' change ordinary days?

2. What's one way you could live 'on mission' this week?

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

Living Sent


What's the most important thing you've learned in this study?


How will you live your faith more openly?


Write a prayer committing to follow and share Jesus.

SMALL GROUP DISCUSSION

Commissioned

The final discussion of the book. You are sent.

- 1.** What's the biggest thing you're taking from this study?

- 2.** How will you keep growing and living your faith?

- 3.** How can this group keep encouraging each other's mission?

MEMORY & MEDITATION

Hide This Word in Your Heart

1 JOHN 5:12

"1 John 5:12"

Context

Look back over the verses you studied in this book.

Why It Matters

Scripture memorized becomes a resource the Holy Spirit can bring to mind in real moments of decision, temptation, doubt, and encouragement.

Write It From Memory

LIVE IT OUT THIS WEEK

Choose one verse from this book to carry with you all week.

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

Memory Verse Review

Write out from memory: 1 John 5:12

Write out from memory: 2 Peter 3:18

Write out from memory: John 13:35

Write out from memory: Romans 12:2

Write out from memory: Ephesians 2:10

SELF-ASSESSMENT

Spiritual Check-In

Rate each statement honestly. This is between you and God - there are no wrong answers, only honest starting points.

1 = rarely 5 = consistently

I make time to read the Bible on my own.

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

I pray about real things in my life, not just at meals.

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

I can explain what I believe and why.

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

I treat people the way Jesus would.

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

I invite God into my decisions before I make them.

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

I am honest even when it costs me.

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

I serve others without expecting anything back.

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

I go to God first when I am anxious or afraid.

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

Final Reflection


How has your faith become more your own through this study?


What's your plan to keep growing?


Write a prayer owning your faith and committing to follow Jesus.

NOTES

Study Notes

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